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From Savings to Sovereignty

European Growth Pension and Insurance Summit
TechBBQ, Copenhagen, 25 Aug 2026

TECHBBQ



- 1 Why tech matters

- 2 The rise of European tech

- 3 From Savings to Sovereignty

Europeans save a lot, but invest little in their own tech sector

● Europe incl. UK (518M)

● United States (340M)

13.6% 

SAVING RATE

 11.6%

\$2.0T 
≈\$2.7T at PPP

HOUSEHOLDS SAVE PER YEAR

 \$2.6T

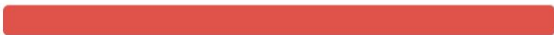
\$30B 

GOES INTO VENTURE FUNDS PER YEAR

 \$100B

\$4.9T 

TECH ENTERPRISE VALUE

 \$40.7T

Downstream effects on innovation and value creation



And downstream effects on household asset gains

GAINS AS A SHARE OF THE ASSETS HELD



GAINS AS A SHARE OF DISPOSABLE INCOME



Valuation gains are increases in the price of assets already held — deposits do not produce them, so a system parked in deposits does not collect them.

Tech is an ownership claim on the future



Market share of critical technologies

United States China & Taiwan Europe

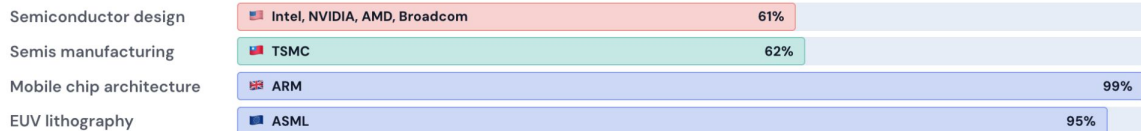
APPLICATION LAYER



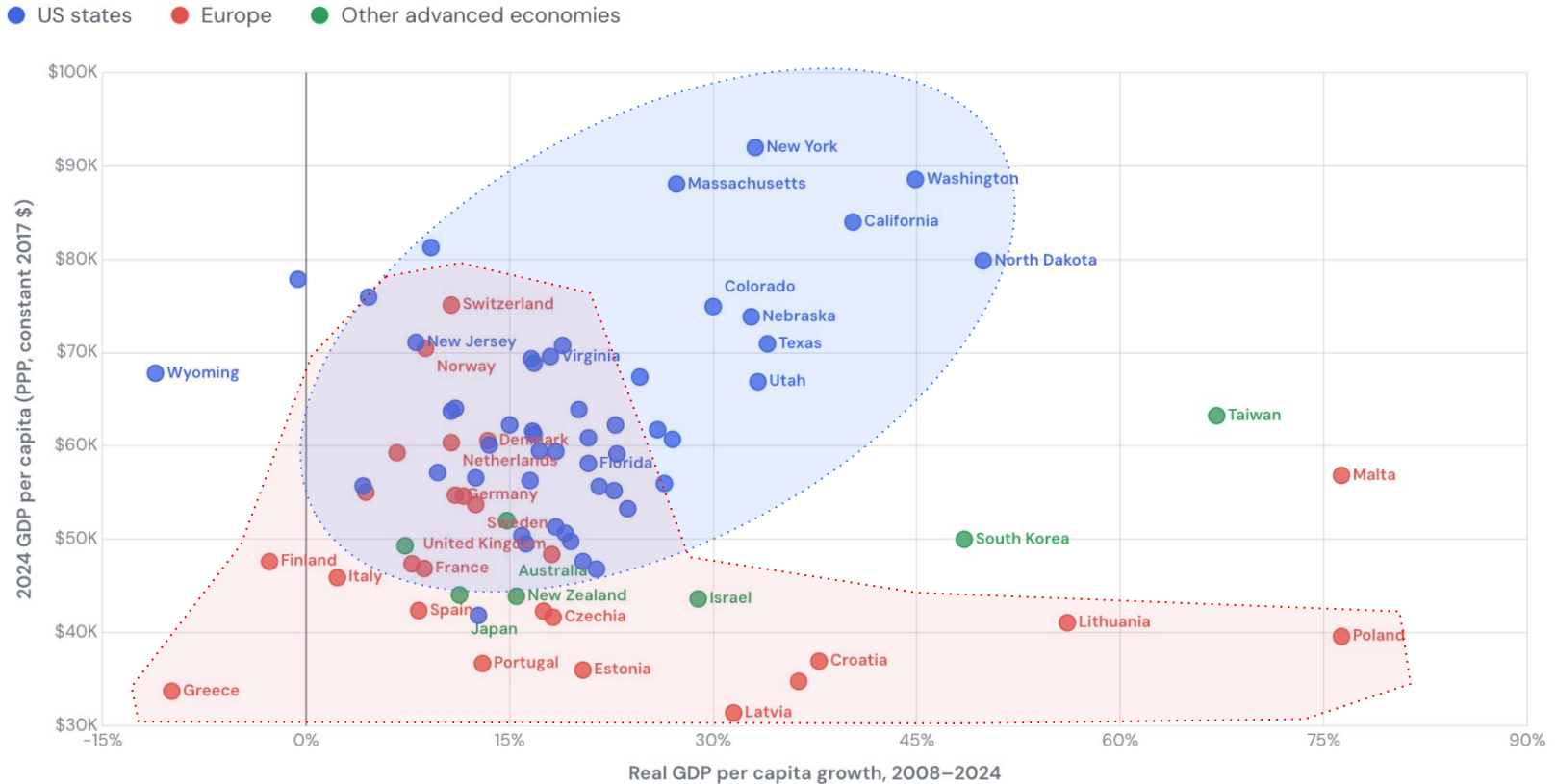
FOUNDATIONAL LAYER



COMPUTE LAYER



Tech drives economic growth and fiscal strength

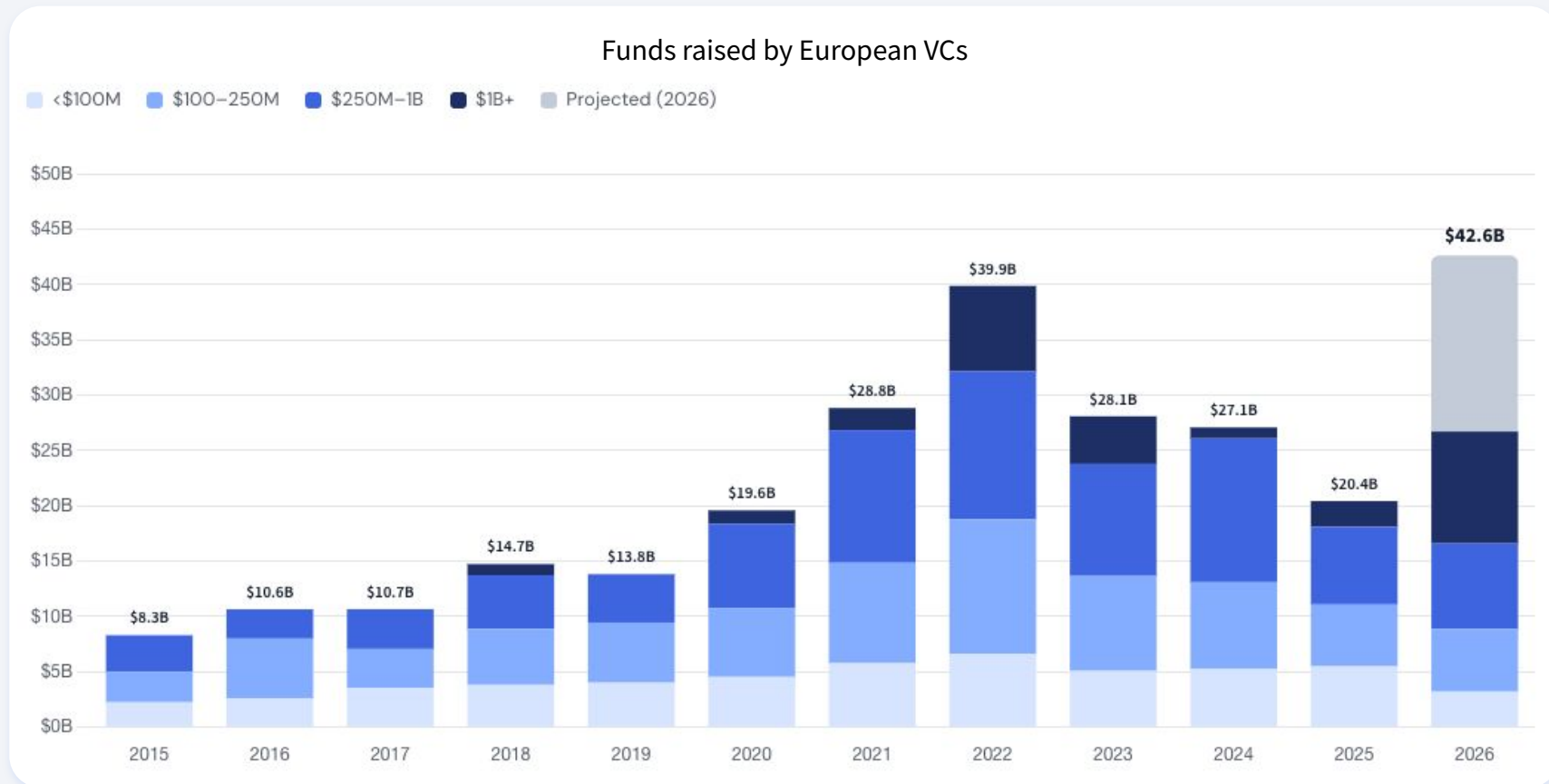


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2 The rise of European tech

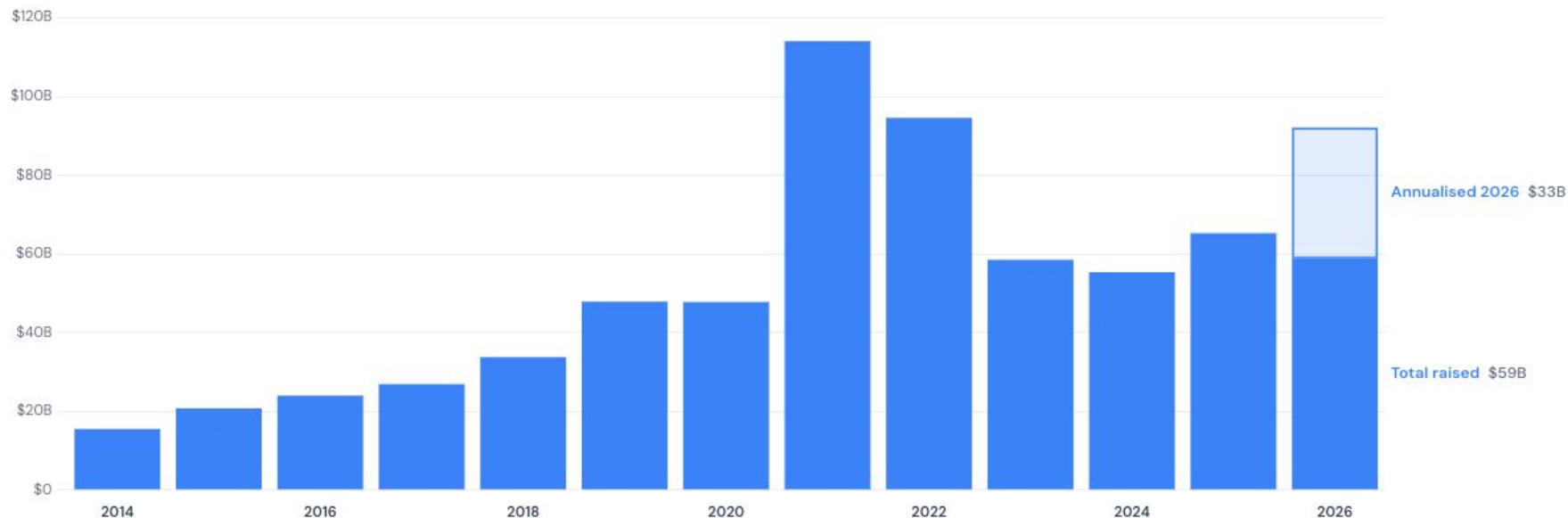
3 From Savings to Sovereignty

Record VC fundraising in Europe – with some help from government



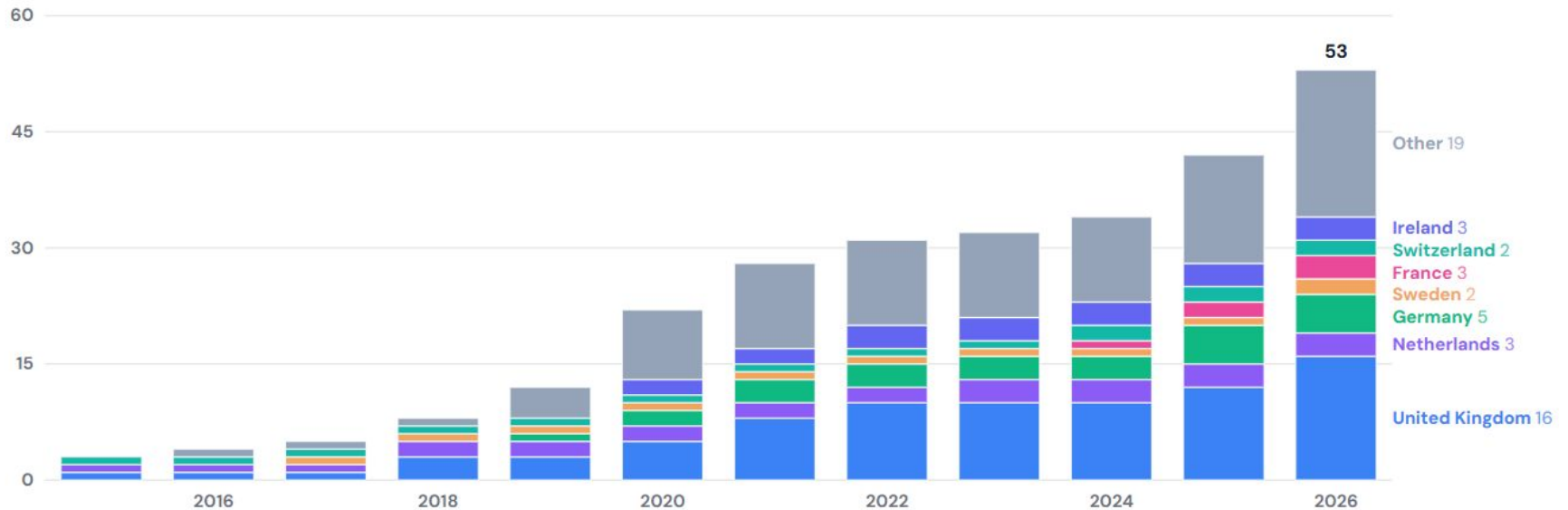
VC investment in European companies is on the rise again

VC investment in European companies



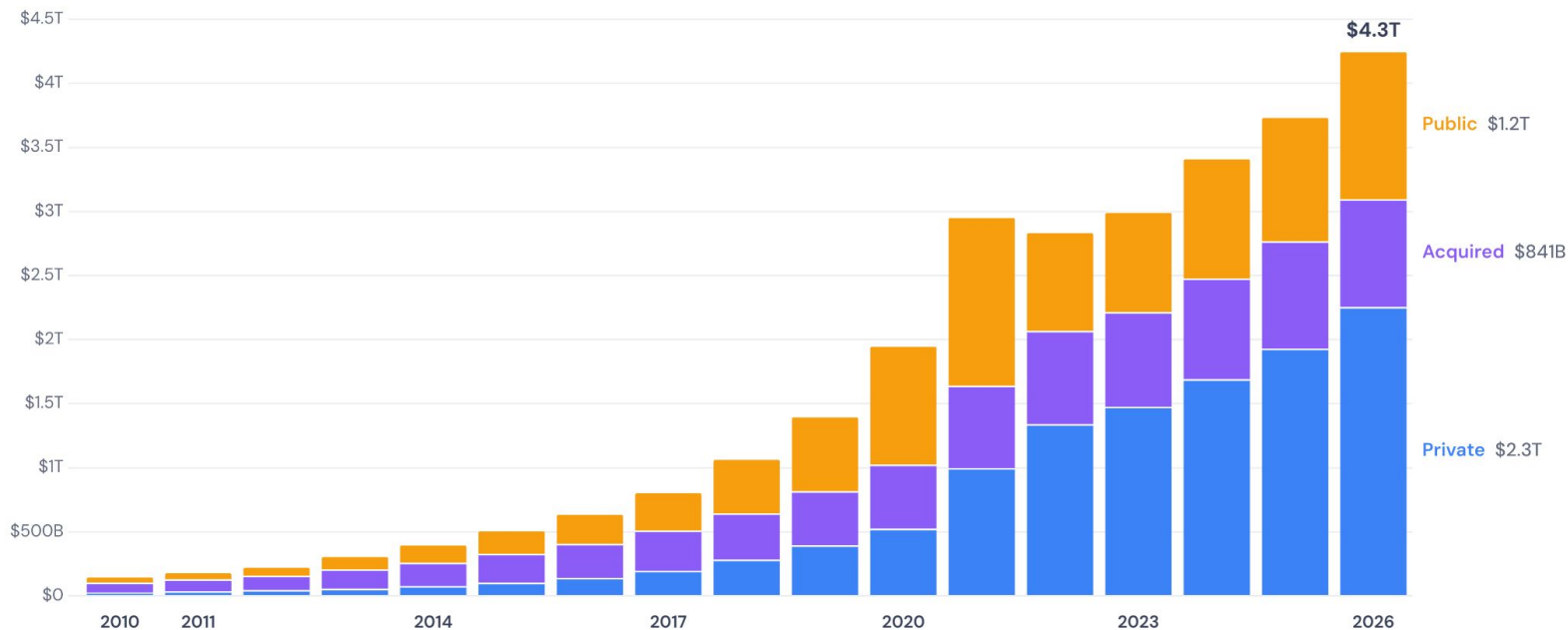
53 European decacorns

European Decacorns worth \$10B+ today, by the year each first crossed it. Country of HQ or founding



Europe's VC-backed ecosystem has grown to \$4.3 trillion

Combined enterprise value of VC backed companies founded since 1990

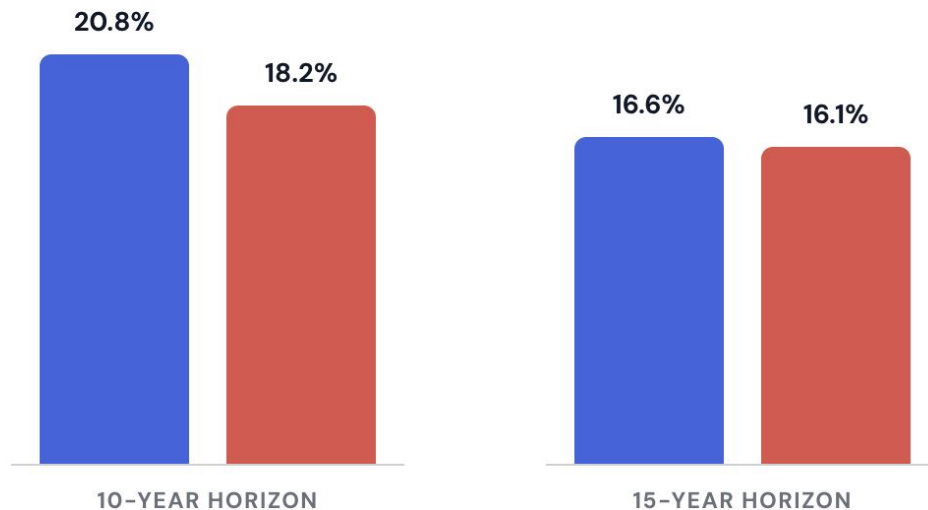


Attractive & proven: investment returns in European VC are not the issue

Net return after fees, % a year

● Europe venture

● North America venture



Source: Invest Europe / Cambridge Associates, The Performance of European Private Equity (2024) *

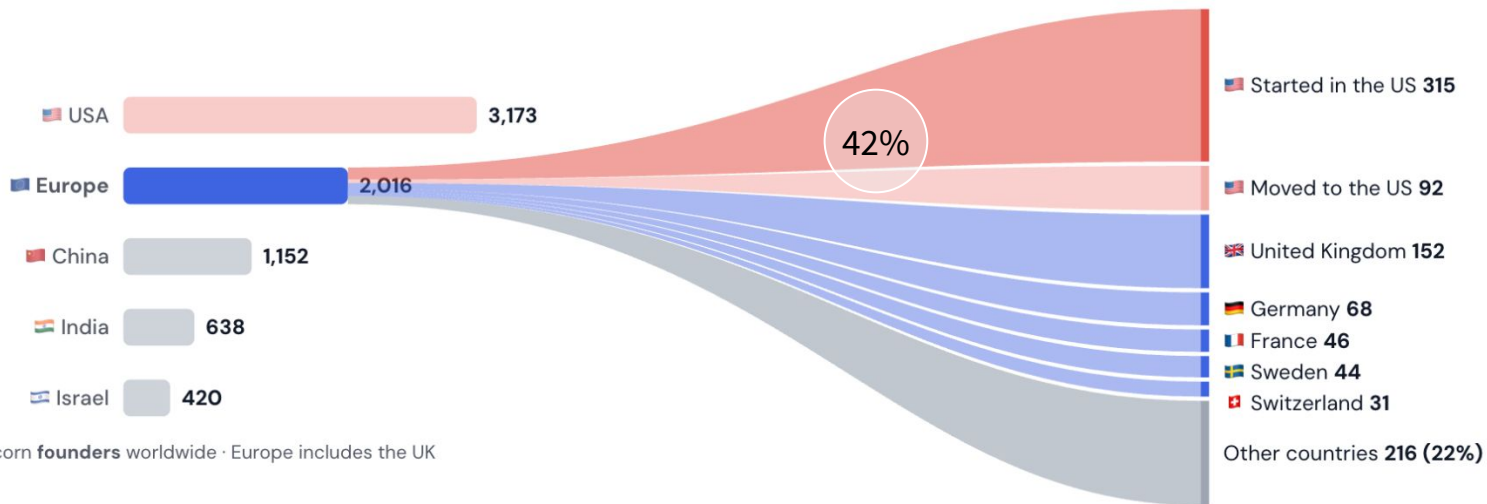


Europe has the entrepreneurial talent but many choose the US to build

European Unicorn Founders

● Started in the US ● Moved to the US ● Built in Europe ● Other countries

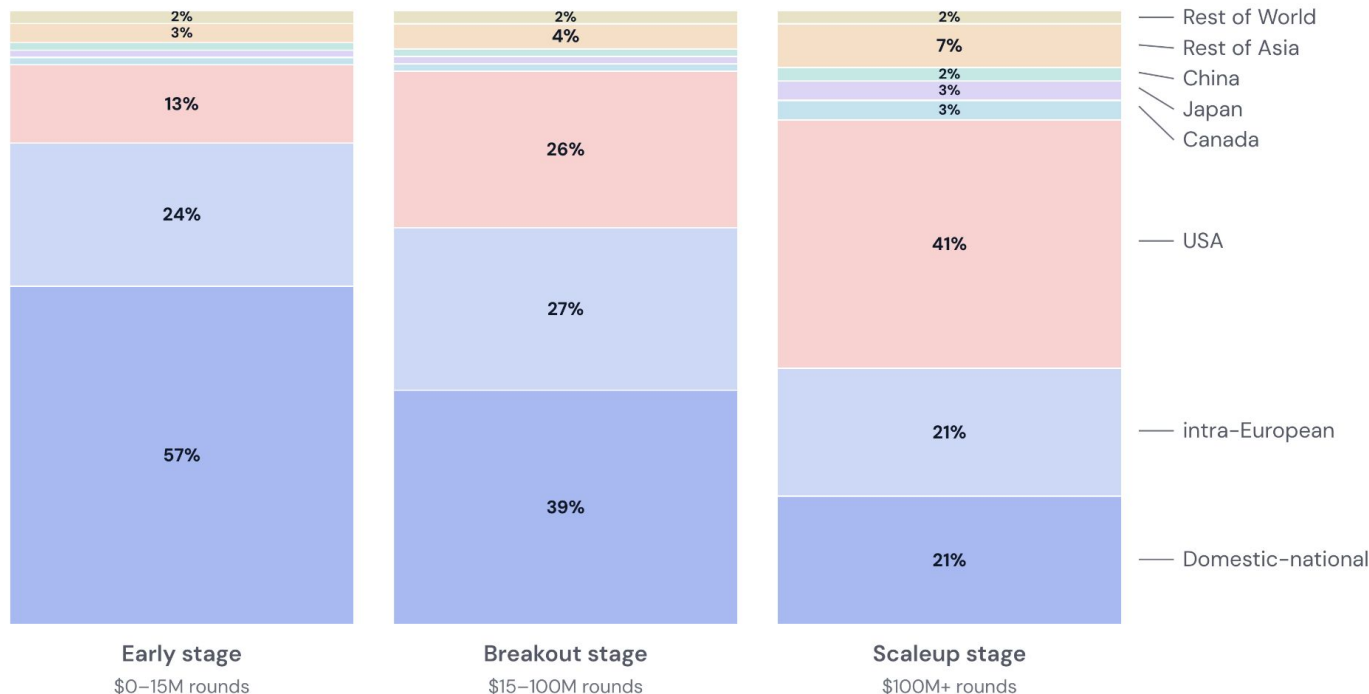
The 964 unicorns they founded — by where they were built



8,796 unicorn founders worldwide · Europe includes the UK

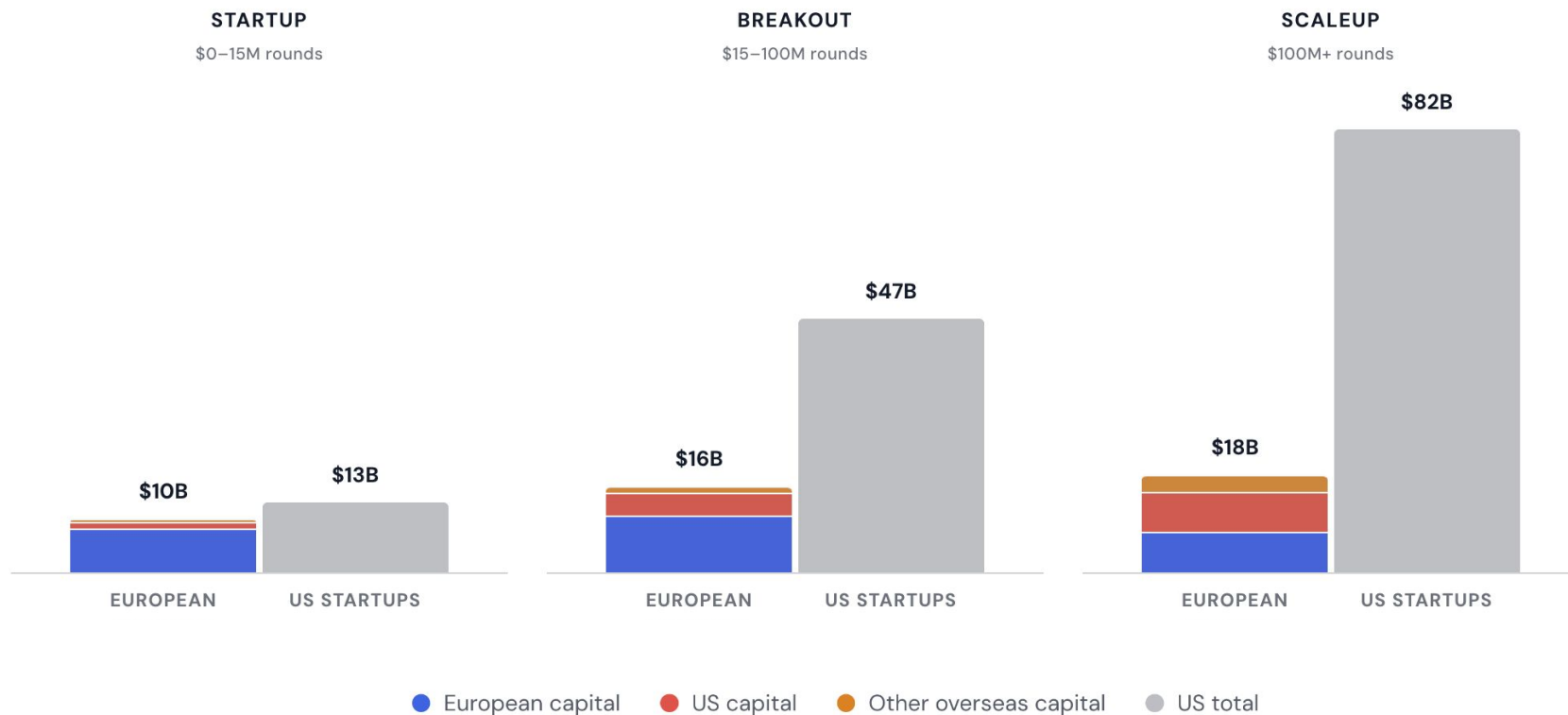
The majority of scaleup capital is coming from overseas

VC funding in European startups by stage and investor location



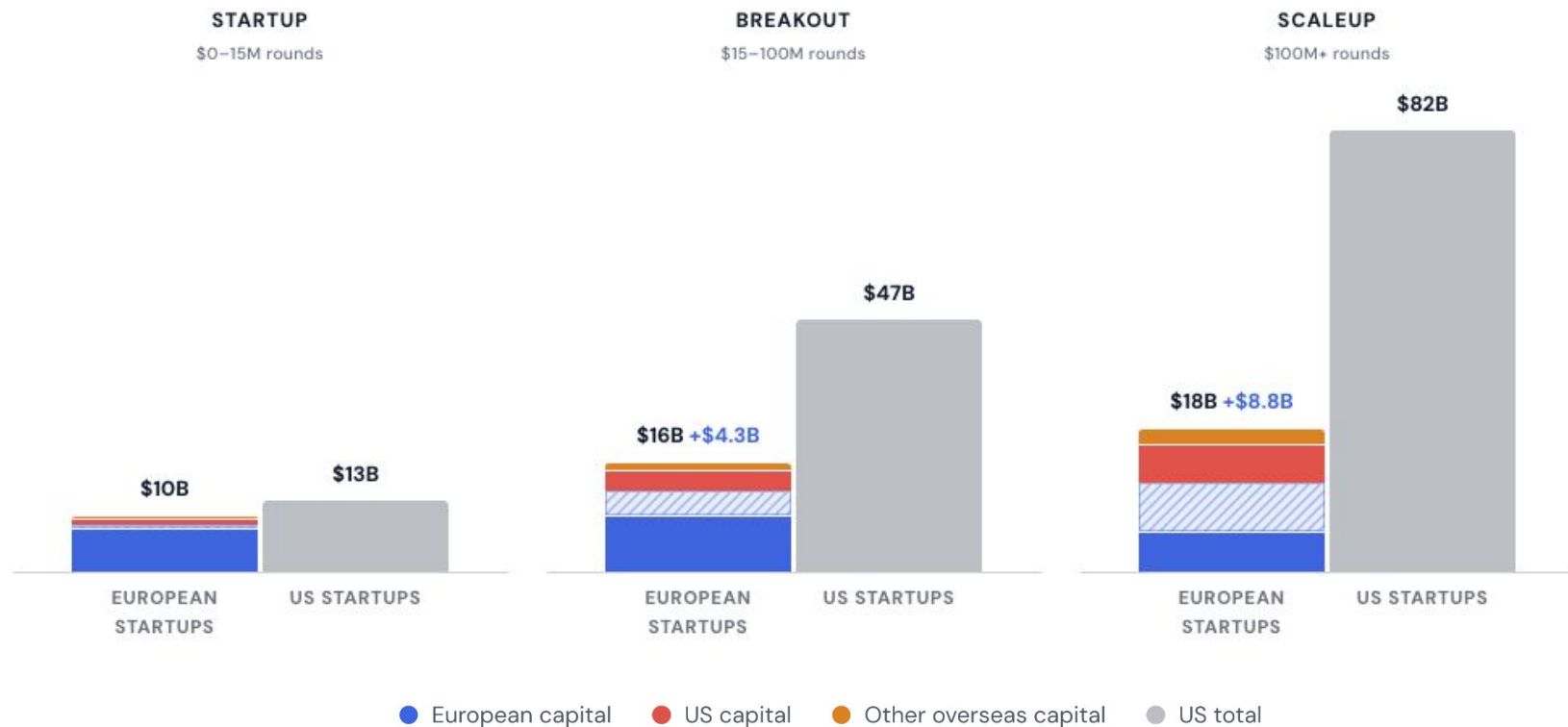
Still, a massive scaleup capital gap

Annual VC deployment into European companies



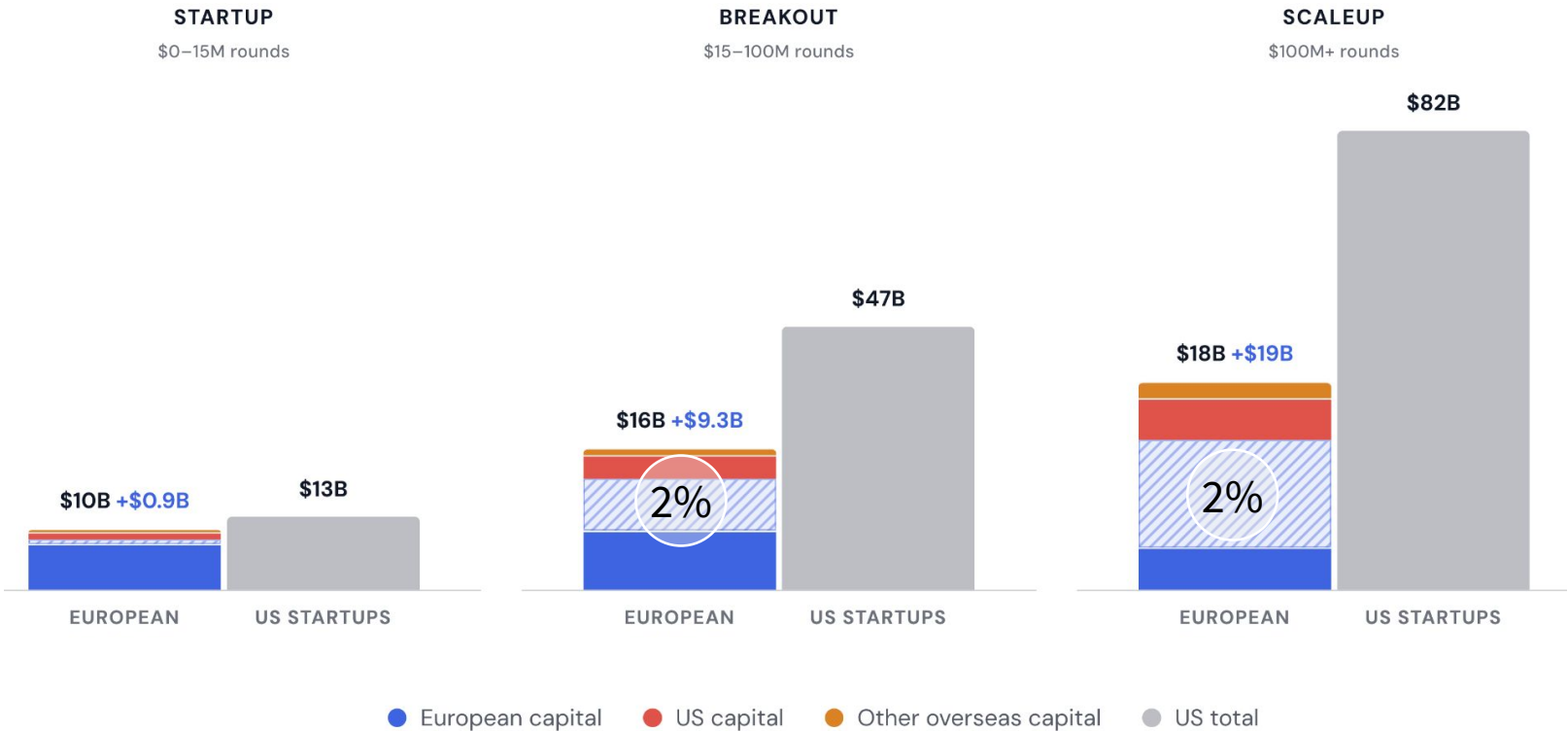
1% would nearly double late stage VC

Annual VC deployment into European companies



2% allocation to VC would transform the industry

Annual VC deployment into European companies



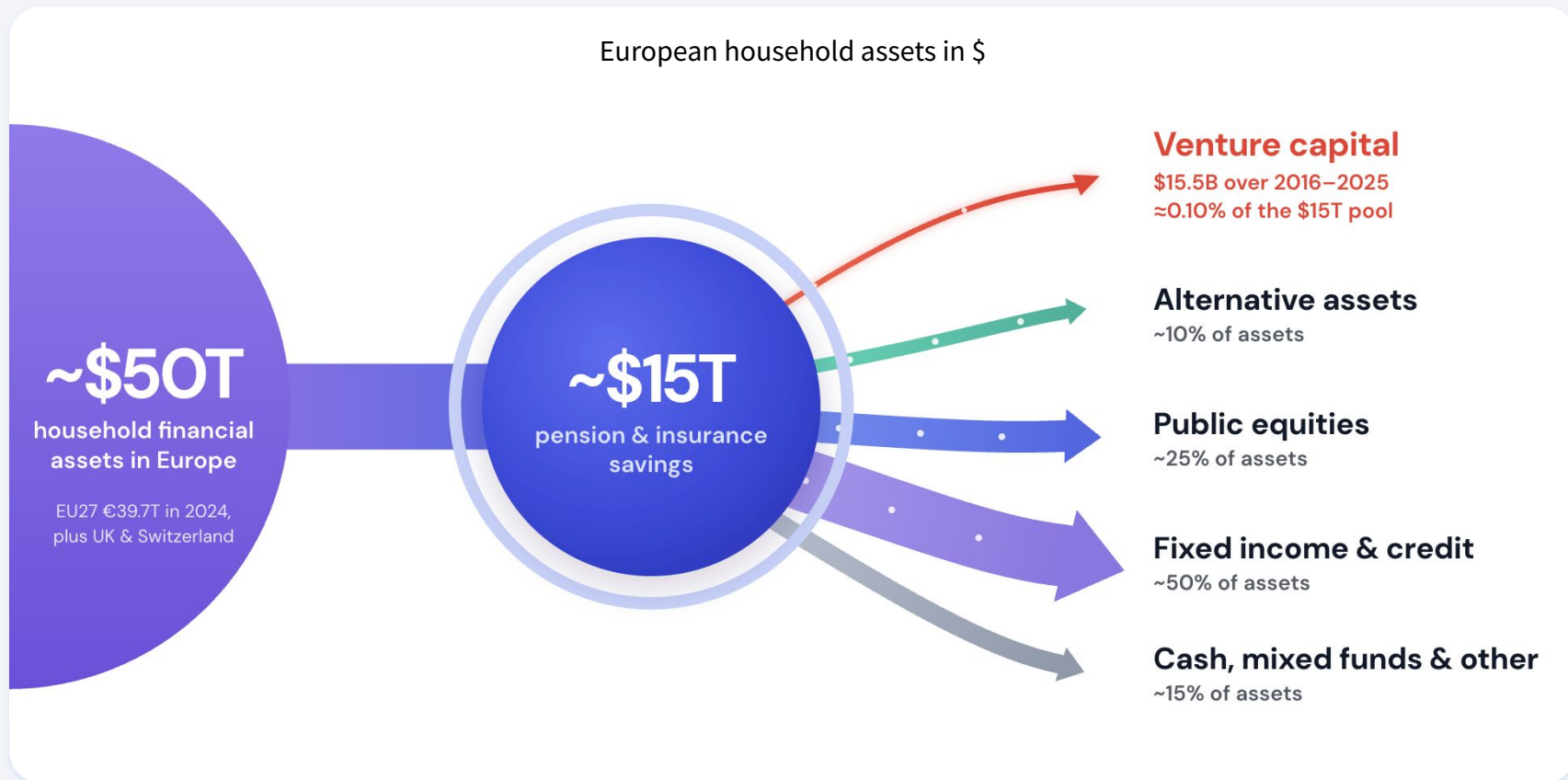
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\$15 trillion in pension & insurance assets

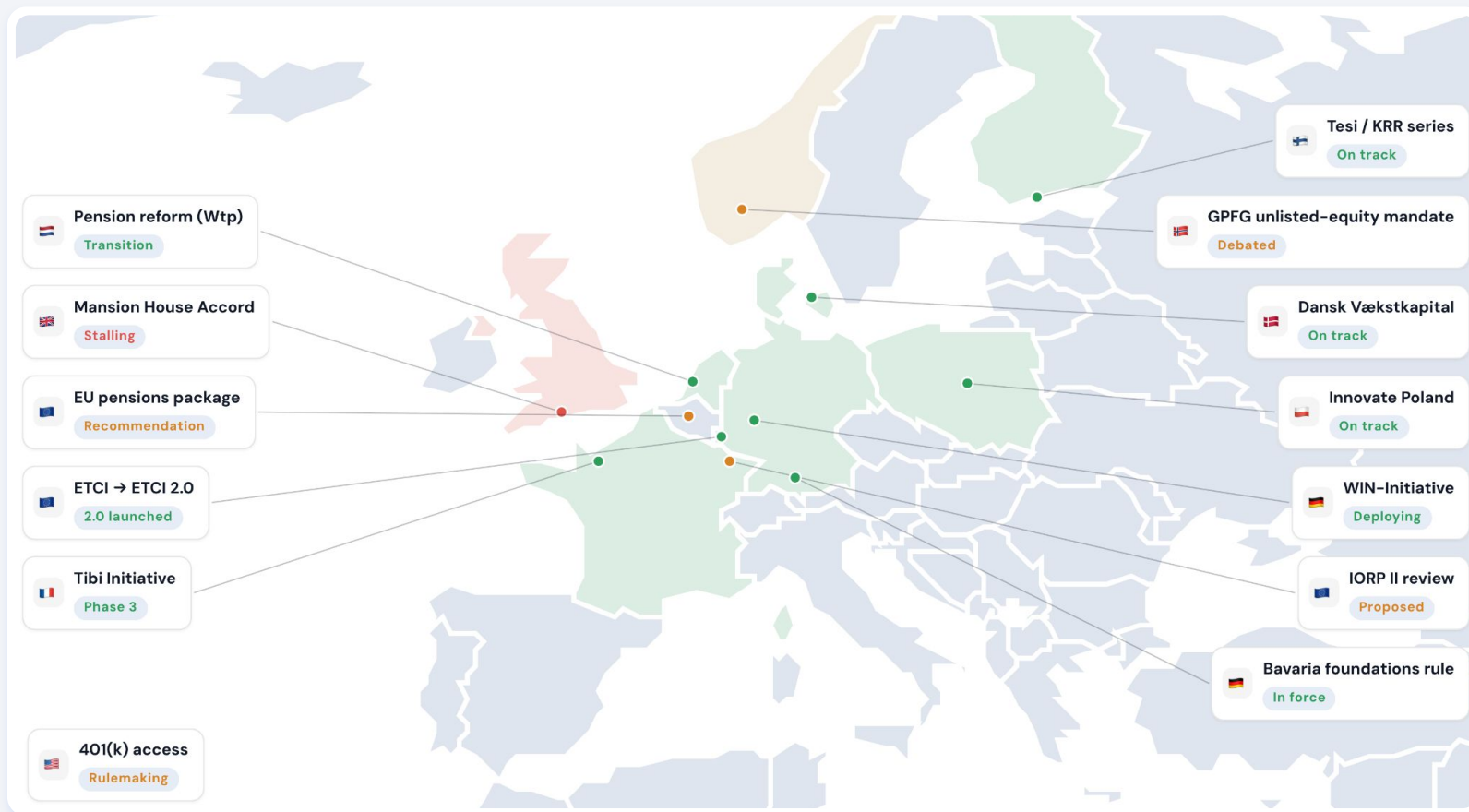
Pension & insurance assets in Europe



Only ~0.1% is allocated to VC

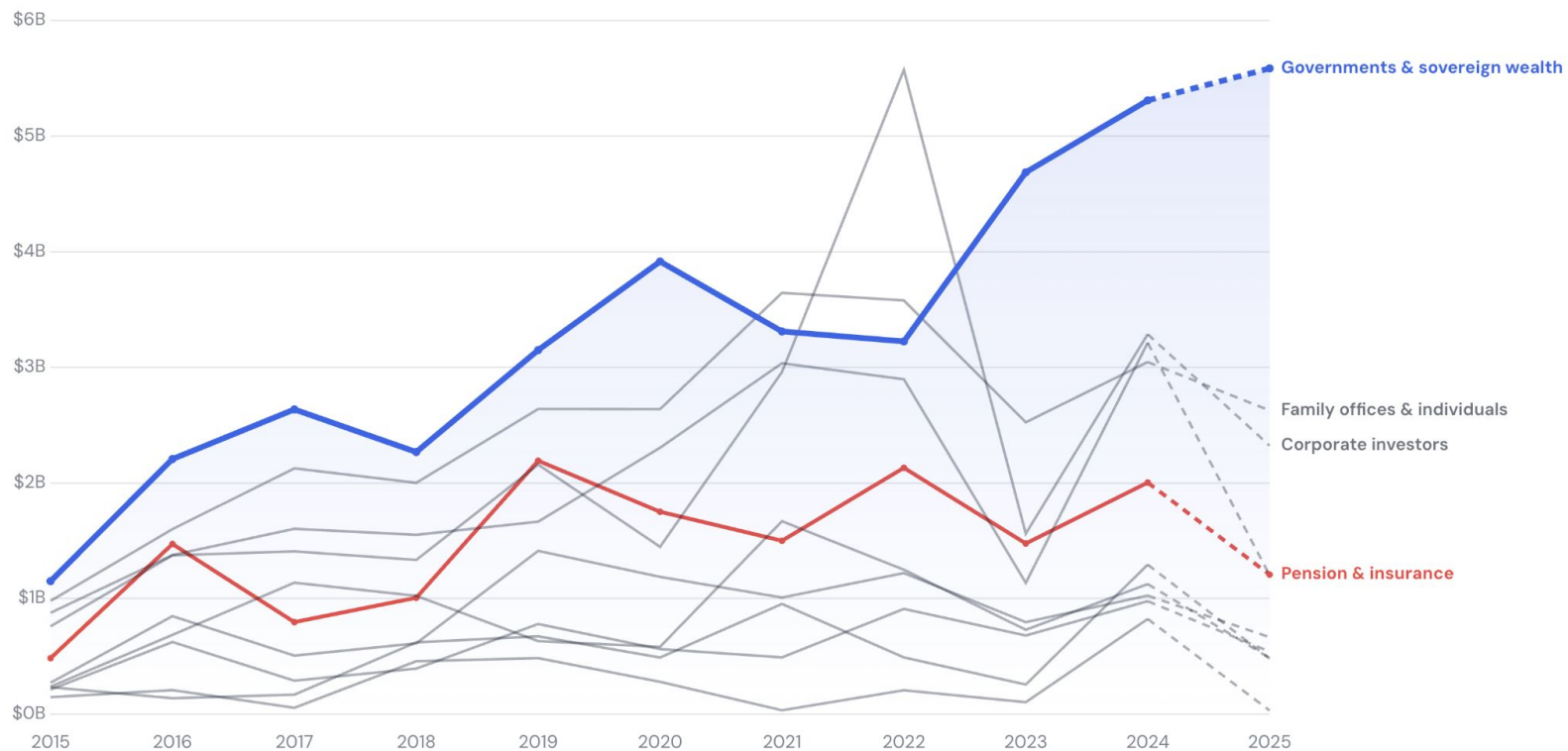


Initiatives to unlock pension capital



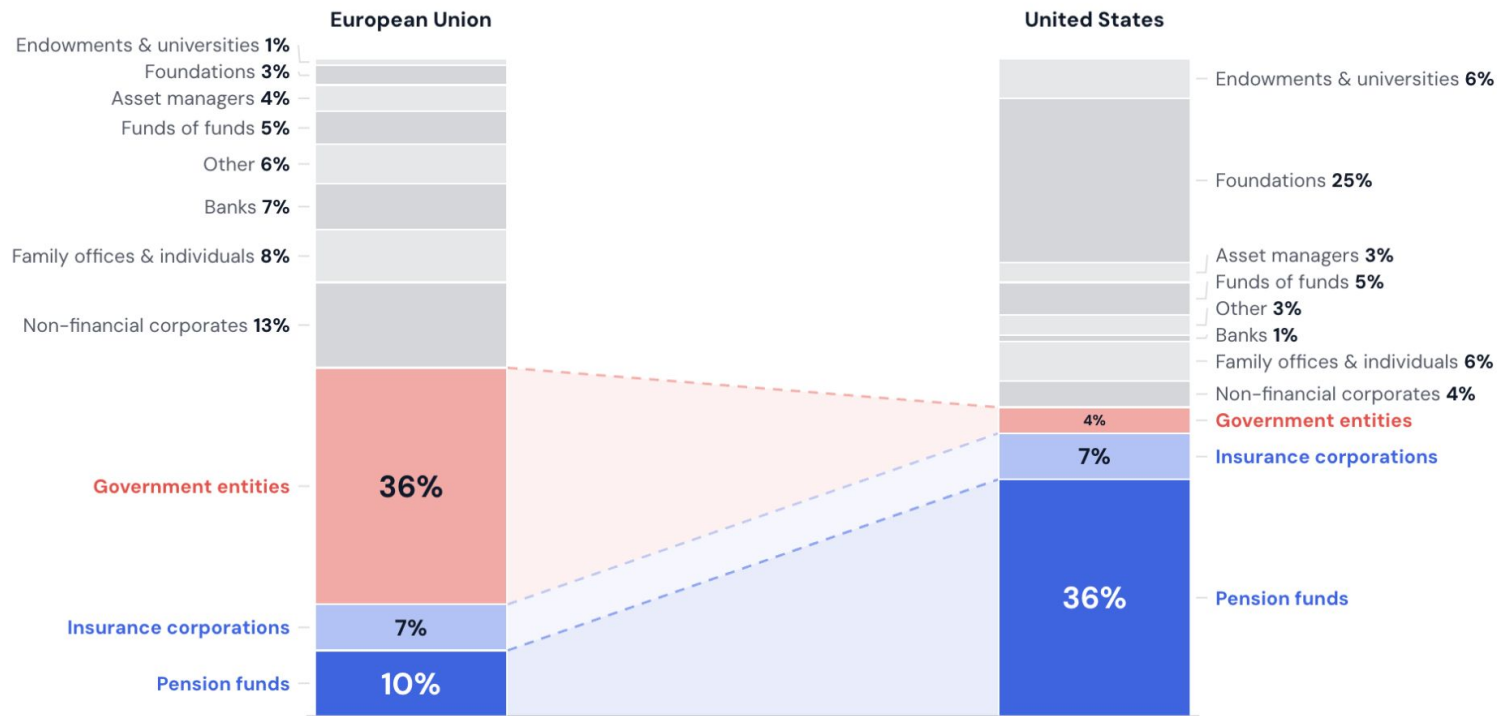
Europe's visible hand

Where VC firms raise from (2015 – 2025)



Europe's visible hand

Where VC firms raise from (number of commitments)



Rules matter: how US prudent-man change boosted VC in '79

How a rule change unlocked billions in pensions

BEFORE

1978

RAISED BY US VENTURE FUNDS

 **\$424M**

OF WHICH PENSION FUNDS

 **\$64M · 15%**

THE CHANGE

1979

The US Department of Labor clarified that the “prudent-man rule” assesses risk across the whole portfolio. As a result, a venture commitment is no longer imprudent on its own.

AFTER

1986

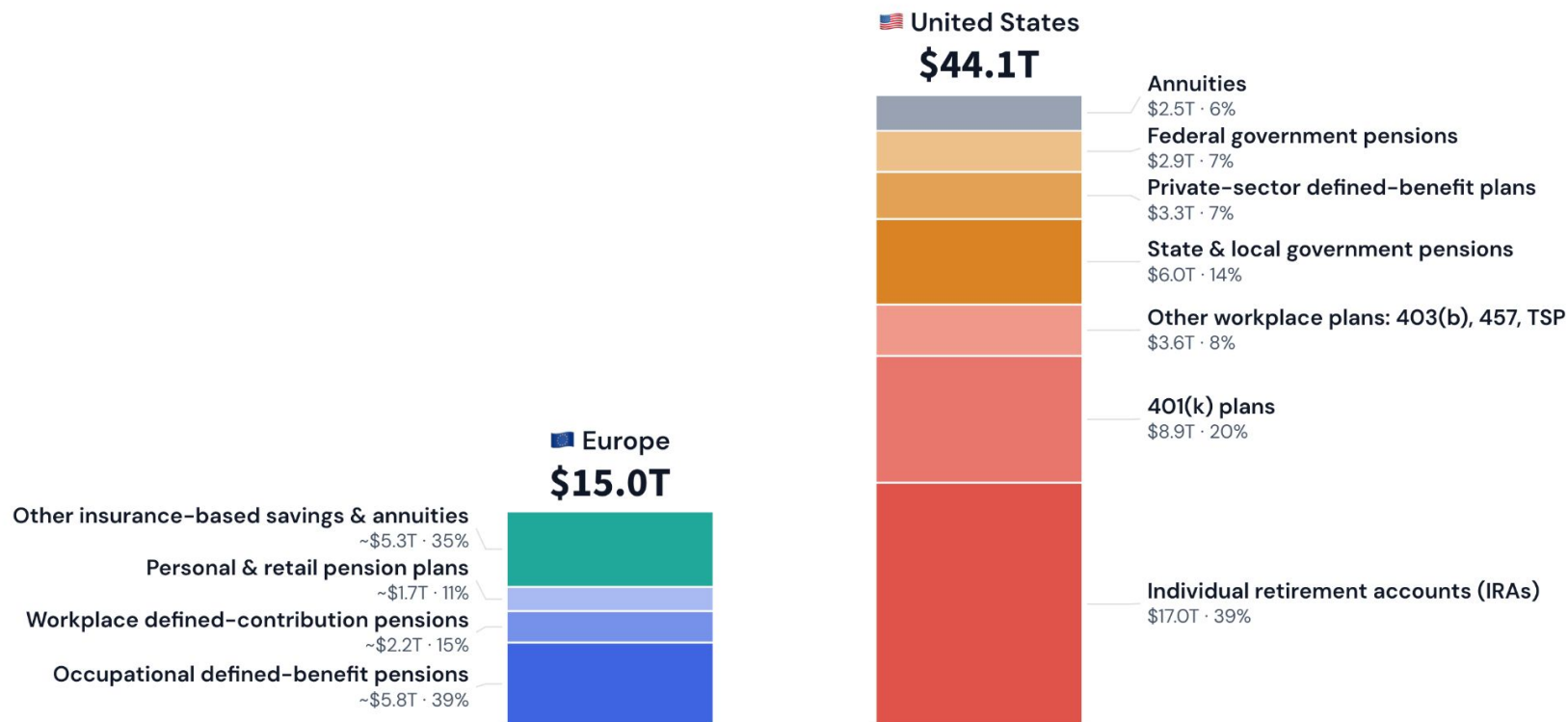
RAISED BY US VENTURE FUNDS

 **>\$4B**

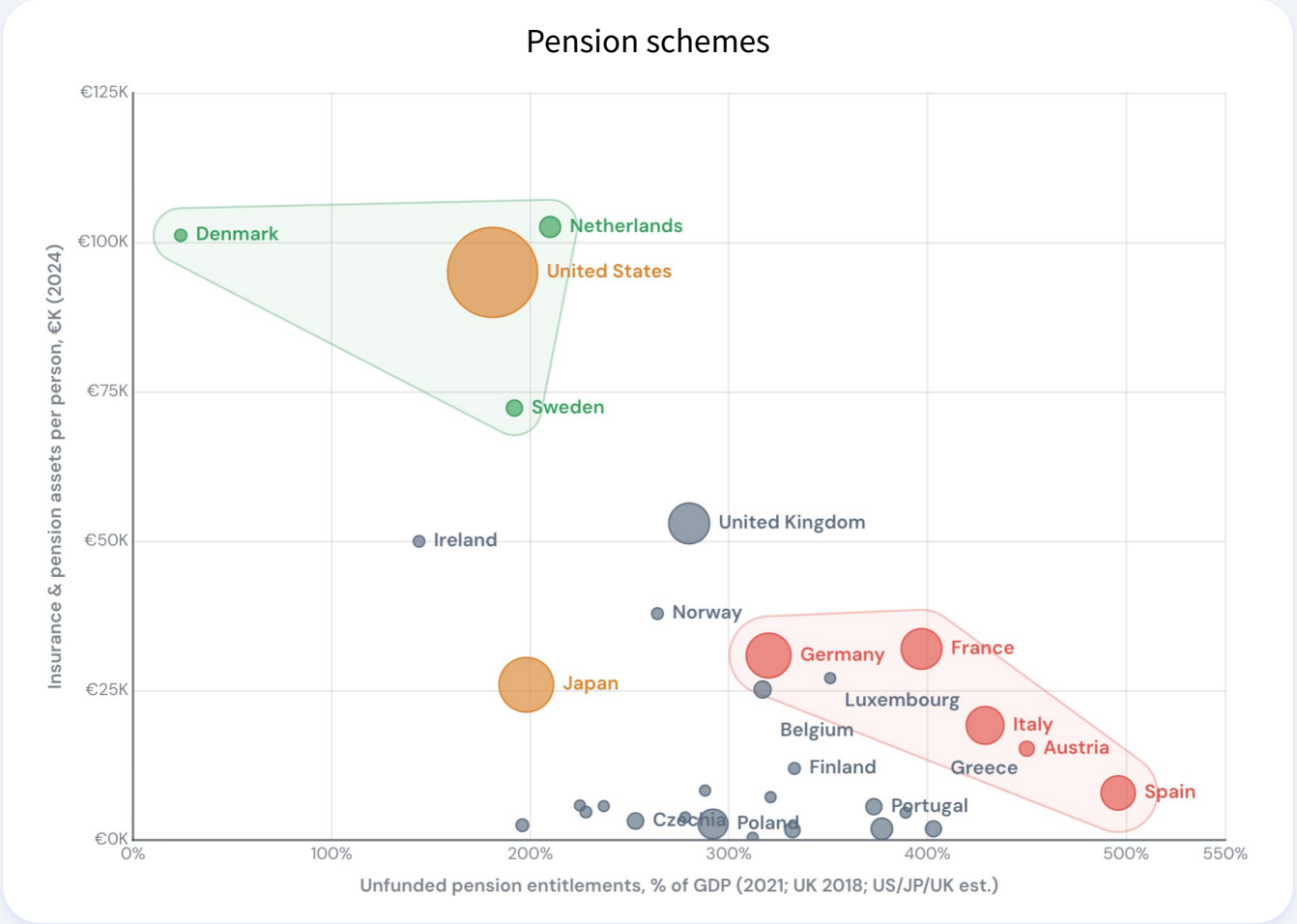
OF WHICH PENSION FUNDS

 **>\$2B · >50%**

US total pension and insurance assets are also 3x bigger



Unfunded PAYG schemes still dominate in the EU's major economies



Solving the puzzle: there are many levers

1 Cost

Pension products are compared on annual fees. Venture returns take a decade to show.

2 Scale

A large fund invests €50–100M per ticket. Most European venture funds cannot absorb that.

3 Capacity

Venture needs a specialist team. A small allocation does not pay for one.

4 Access

The best funds are oversubscribed. Average funds may not justify the risk and illiquidity.

5 Governance

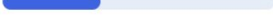
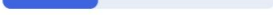
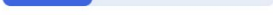
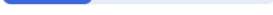
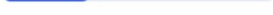
Approvals, national rules and headline risk — all out of proportion to a small ticket.

6 Fragmentation

27 pension systems, and few vehicles that bridge them at pension size.

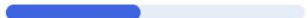
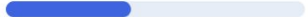
Lack of transparency is itself a barrier, so Dealroom is making the market visible.

Top pension funds backing VC firms worldwide (2015–2025)

#	PENSION FUND	AUM	% VC	VC AUM	VCS BACKED	POWER-LAW SCORE
1	 AP2	\$44B	5%	\$2B	52	 80K
2	 ATP	\$116B	5%	\$6B	56	 77K
3	 Hampshire Pension Fund	\$9B	1%	\$90M	48	 57K
4	 Industriens Pension	\$31B	5%	\$2B	84	 53K
5	 West Midlands Pension Fund	\$25B	1%	\$250M	69	 46K
6	 Keva	\$70B	3%	\$2B	68	 29K
7	 AP3	\$51B	5%	\$3B	45	 28K
8	 Border to Coast Pensions Partnership	\$60B	—	—	38	 27K
9	 Elo	\$30B	3%	\$900M	85	 26K
10	 AP6	\$5B	5%	\$250M	24	 26K

Lack of transparency is itself a barrier, so Dealroom is making the market visible.

Top pension funds backing European VC firms (2015–2025)

#	PENSION FUND	AUM	% VC	VC AUM	VCS BACKED	POWER-LAW SCORE	
1	 Keva	\$70B	3%	\$2B	33		12K
2	 ATP	\$116B	5%	\$6B	24		11K
3	 Industriens Pension	\$31B	5%	\$2B	35		10K
4	 AP6	\$5B	5%	\$250M	20		10K
5	 Ilmarinen	\$65B	3%	\$2B	51		8K
6	 French Pension Reserve Fund	\$24B	—	—	17		7K
7	 Elo	\$30B	3%	\$900M	42		6K
8	 West Midlands Pension Fund	\$25B	1%	\$250M	31		6K
9	 AP3	\$51B	5%	\$3B	20		6K
10	 Varma	\$60B	—	—	26		5K

Where the LPs are based

Every country in the current view; the smallest share one tile.

GROUP BY

LP type

VIEW

Location

Bars

Treemap

UNIT OF MEASUREMENT

AuM

PNG

United States
\$60.2T

United Kingdom
\$8.4T

China
\$5.1T

Germany
\$4.7T

South Korea
\$3.6T

Switzerland
\$2.1T

Singapore
\$1.8T

France
\$5.9T

Australia · \$1.7T

Netherlands
\$3.2T

50 other countries
\$11.3T

Japan
\$5.5T

Canada
\$3.1T

Where each group sends its money

Each column splits a group's fund commitments by the fund manager's home region. Home bias is the norm — pick any two groups and read them against the all-LPs baseline.

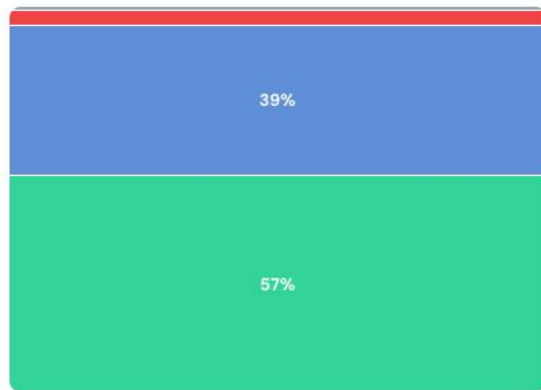
Europe



Pension fund



Europe · Pension fund · 257 LPs · 2,534 fund commitments



24% early-stage managers

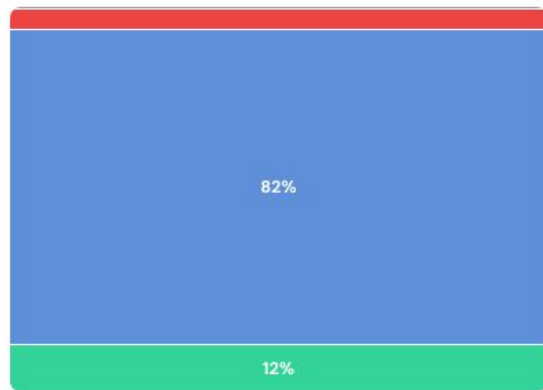
North America



Pension fund



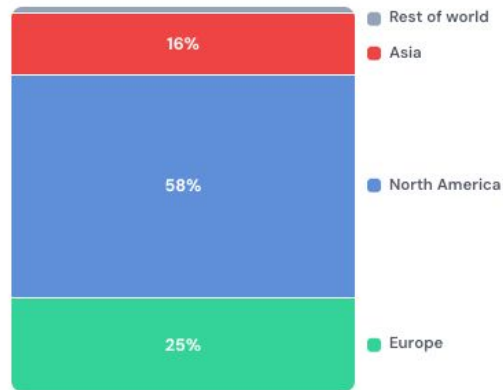
North America · Pension fund · 989 LPs · 11,838 fund commitments



24% early-stage managers

ALL LPS — BASELINE

Every LP in the graph · 9,129 LPs · 45,079 fund commitments



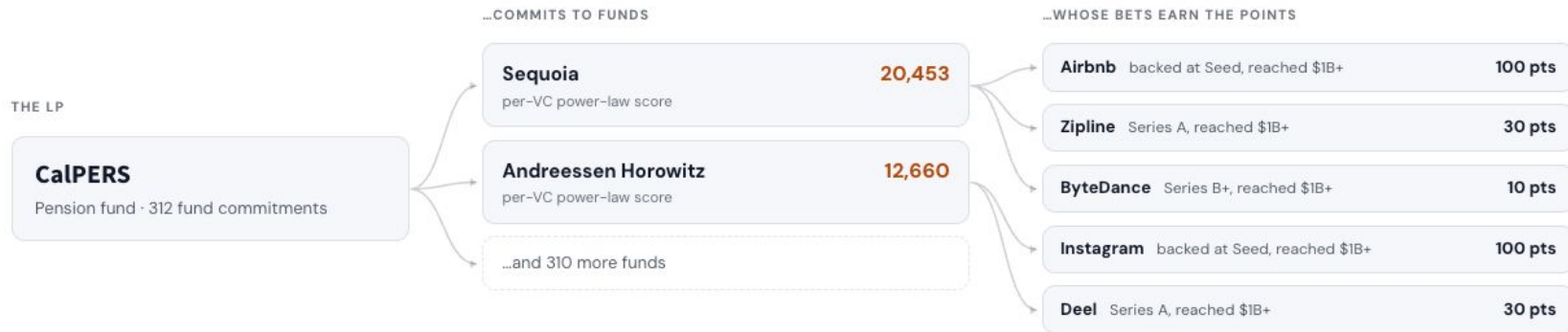
44% early-stage managers

Every fund commitment in the LP graph counts once, whatever the filters above are set to. Early-stage = the manager's preferred entry is pre-seed to Series A.

How the Combined Power-Law Score is built

Every LP commitment to a VC fund is weighted by that fund's **average per-VC power-law score** — itself built from the fund's track record of producing \$1B+ valuations, \$25M+ revenues and \$100M+ revenue outcomes (stage-weighted).

$$\text{Combined Power-Law Score} = \text{Number of LP investments} \times \text{Average Power-Law Score per VC backed}$$



312 commitments × ~733 average score

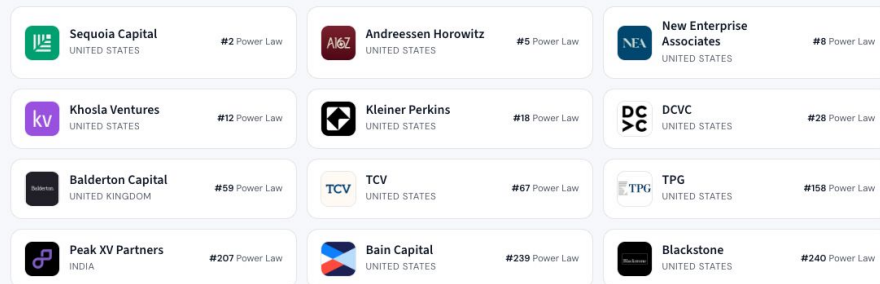
Combined Power-Law Score 228,672

The five market views recompute the score against a different VC universe: *Global/US* (all VCs), *Europe* (European VCs only), *Early stage* (Pre-seed → Series A), *Emerging managers* (Fund I → III) and *European Emerging managers*. AuM and % VC are Dealroom estimates aggregated from public filings, fund prospectuses and disclosed commitments — VC AuM is the product of the two. The full per-fund-commitment graph powering this analysis is unlocked with a Dealroom demo.

The funds AP2 backs.

AP2 is a limited partner in 69 funds. 13 of them place in the [Power Law Investor Ranking](#); those lead, best-ranked first.

All Americas Europe EMEA Asia



How AP2's fund book is spread.

The 69 funds AP2 backs, by where the manager is headquartered and how many funds that manager has raised.



How big the LPs are

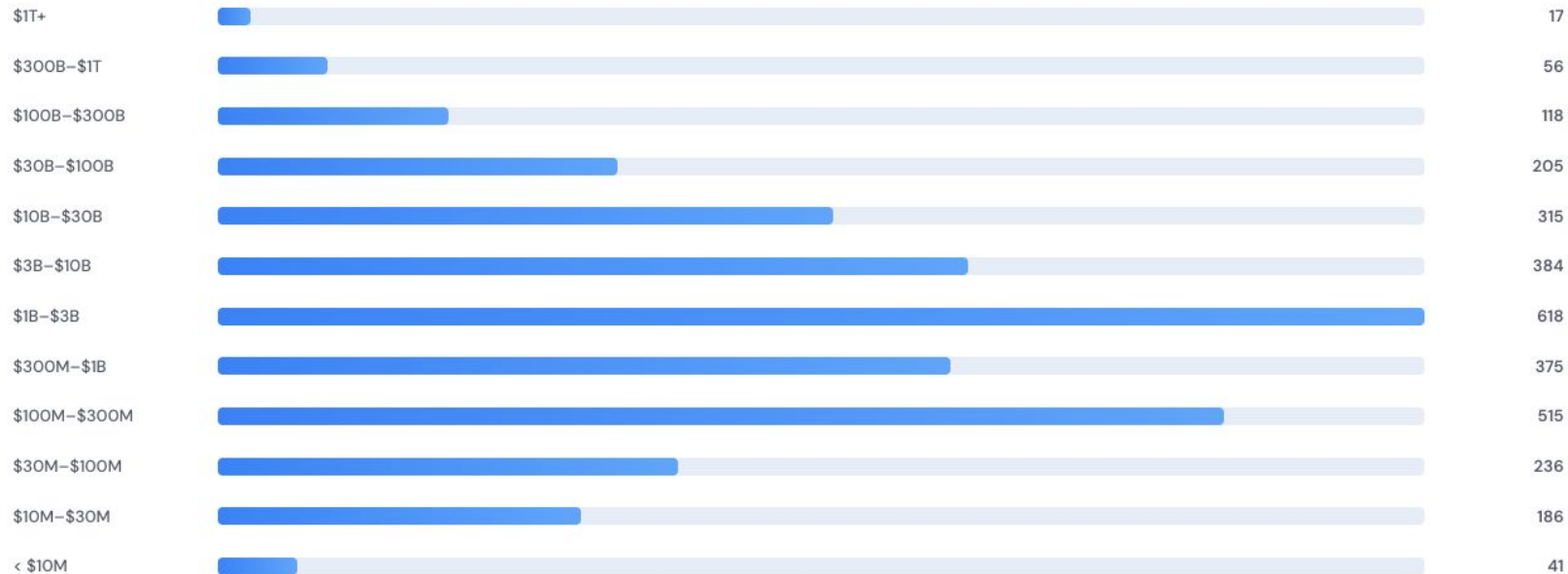
Every LP in the current view, counted into bands of AuM. LPs with none on record are left out.

LP LOCATION

All locations

UNIT OF MEASUREMENT

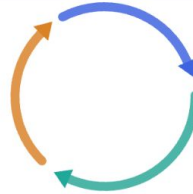
AuM

 PNG

Unlock more capital

pension money into venture, allocated
on merit by experienced investors

Learn from the Nordics



A business-friendly environment

flexible labour markets,
easy to build teams

Learn from the Nordics

One capital market

less friction in services, supervision
and insolvency — the scale that
pension funds need

Letta, Draghi, SIU

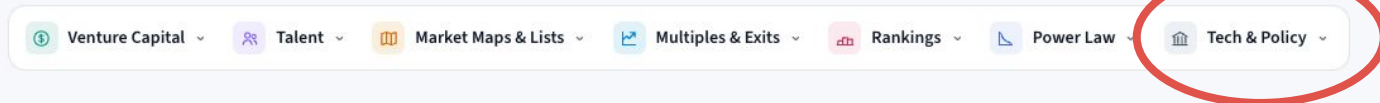
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Resources & Learning

Charts, market maps, and sector deep dives from the Dealroom data team.

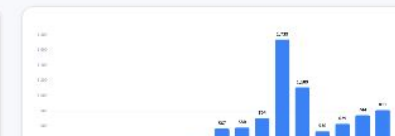
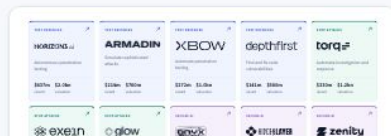
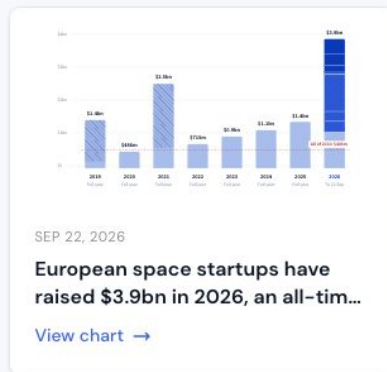
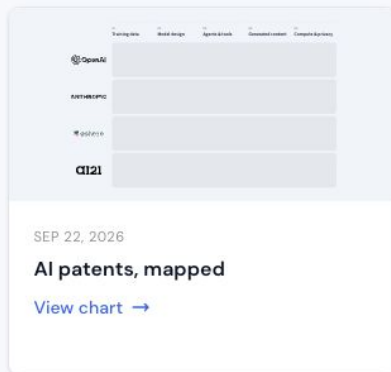
LIVE DASHBOARDS & COLLECTIONS



Gallery



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European Tech Update

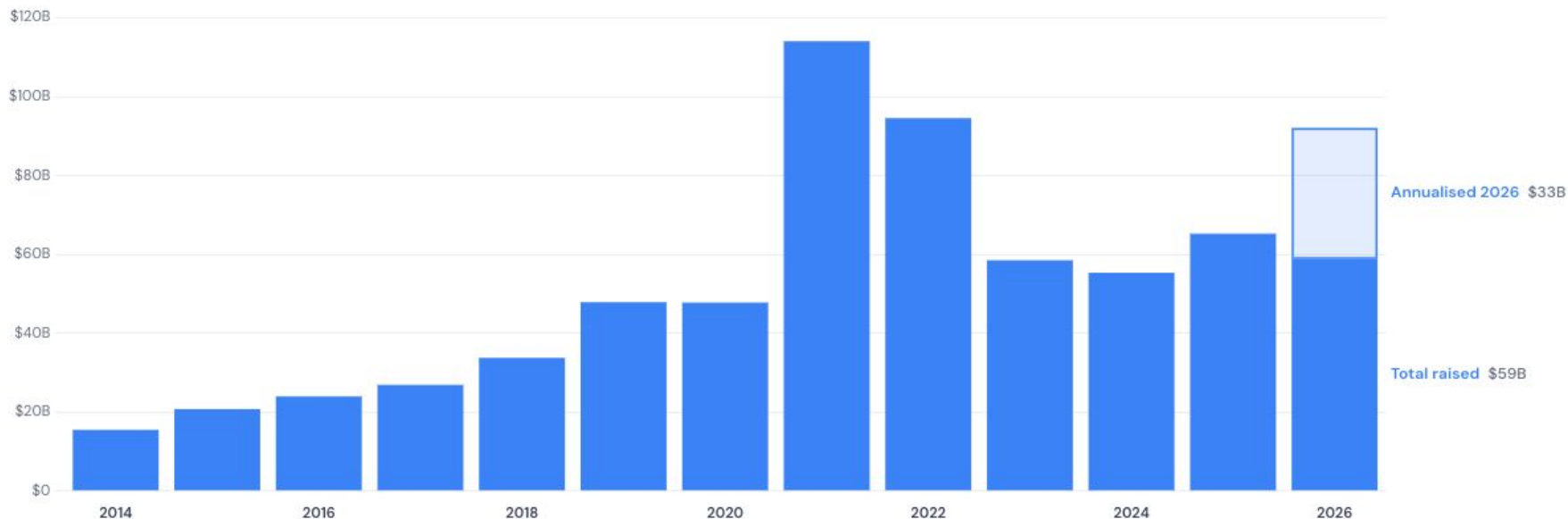
TechBBQ, Copenhagen, 25 Aug 2026

TECHBBQ

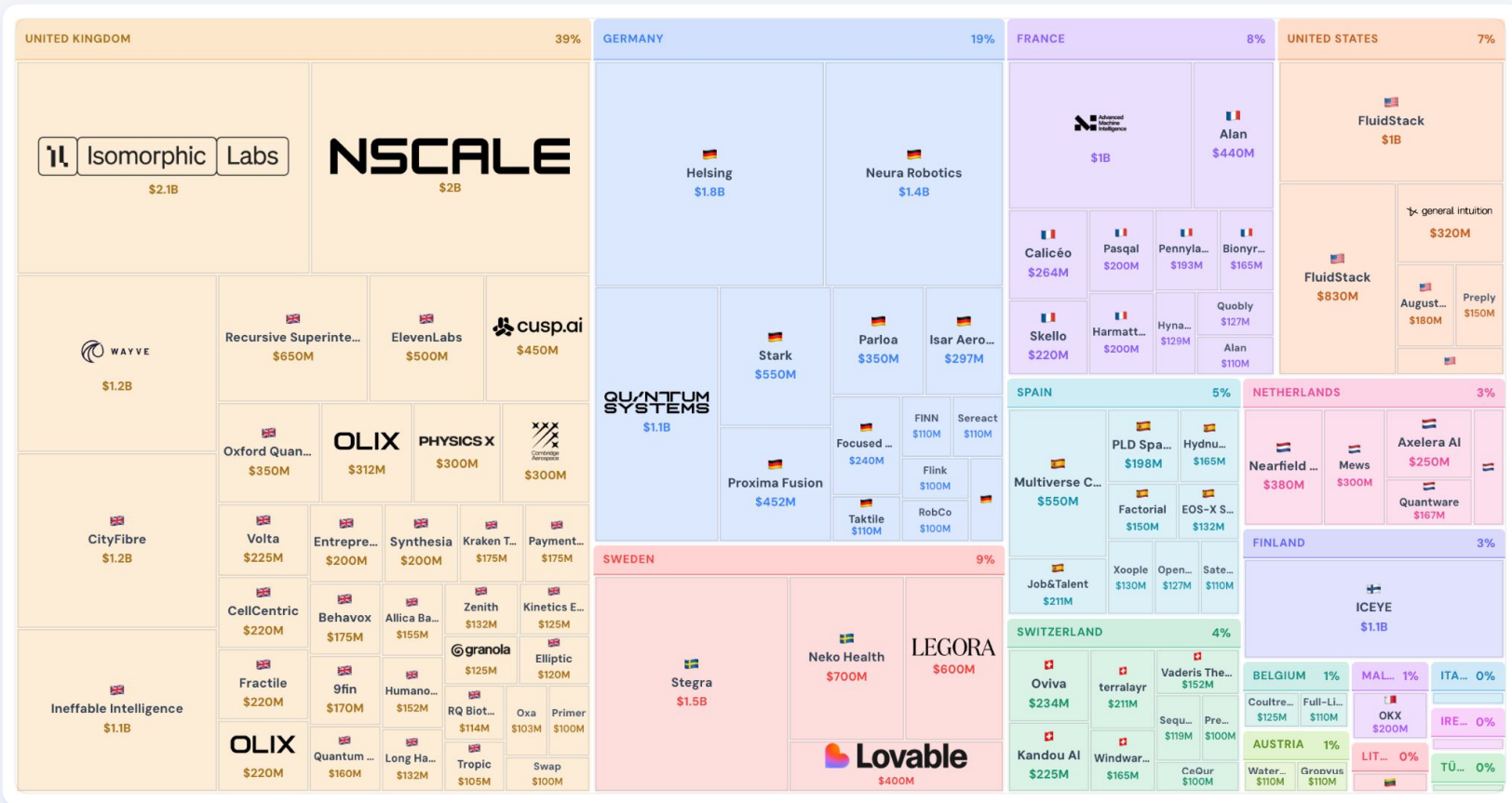


VC investment in European companies is on the rise again

VC investment in European companies

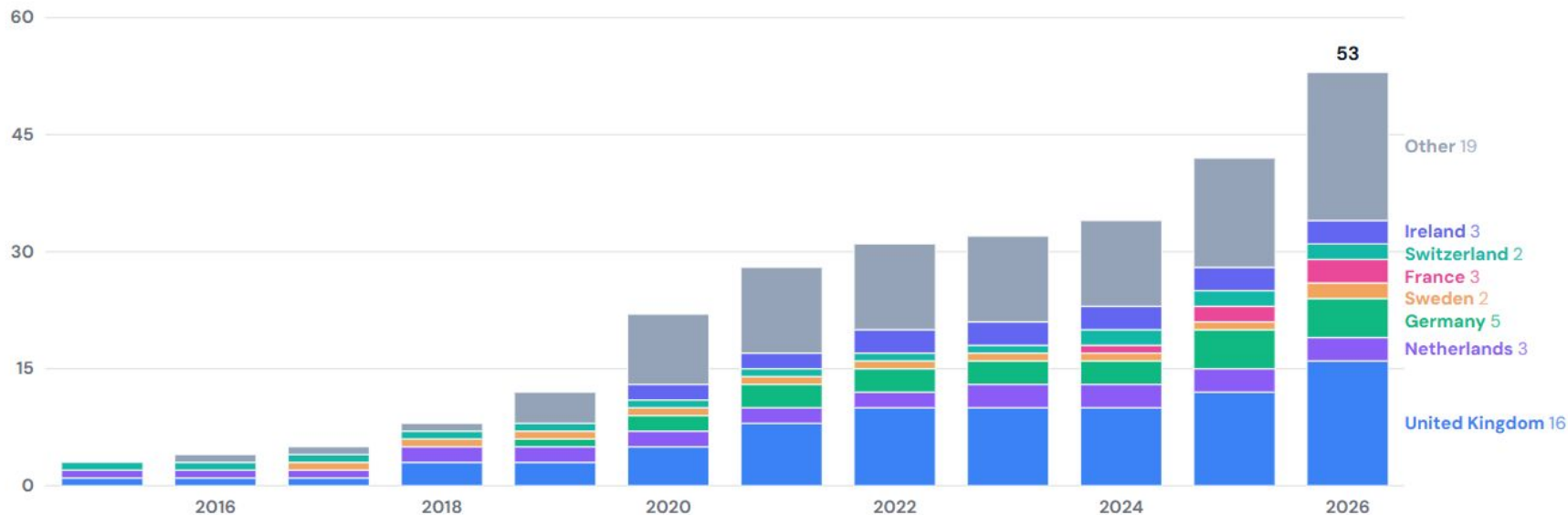


Mega rounds going strong in 2026. Gigarounds smashing previous records



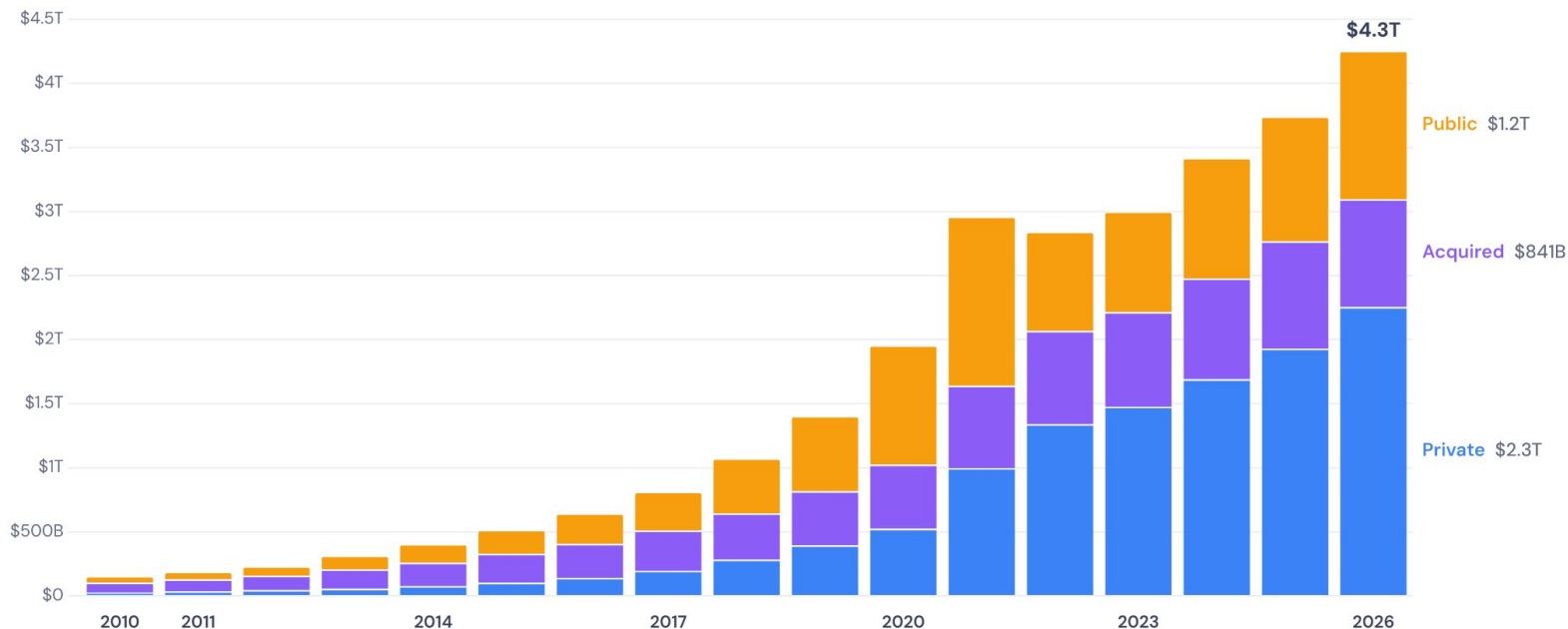
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European Decacorns worth \$10B+ today, by the year each first crossed it. Country of HQ or founding



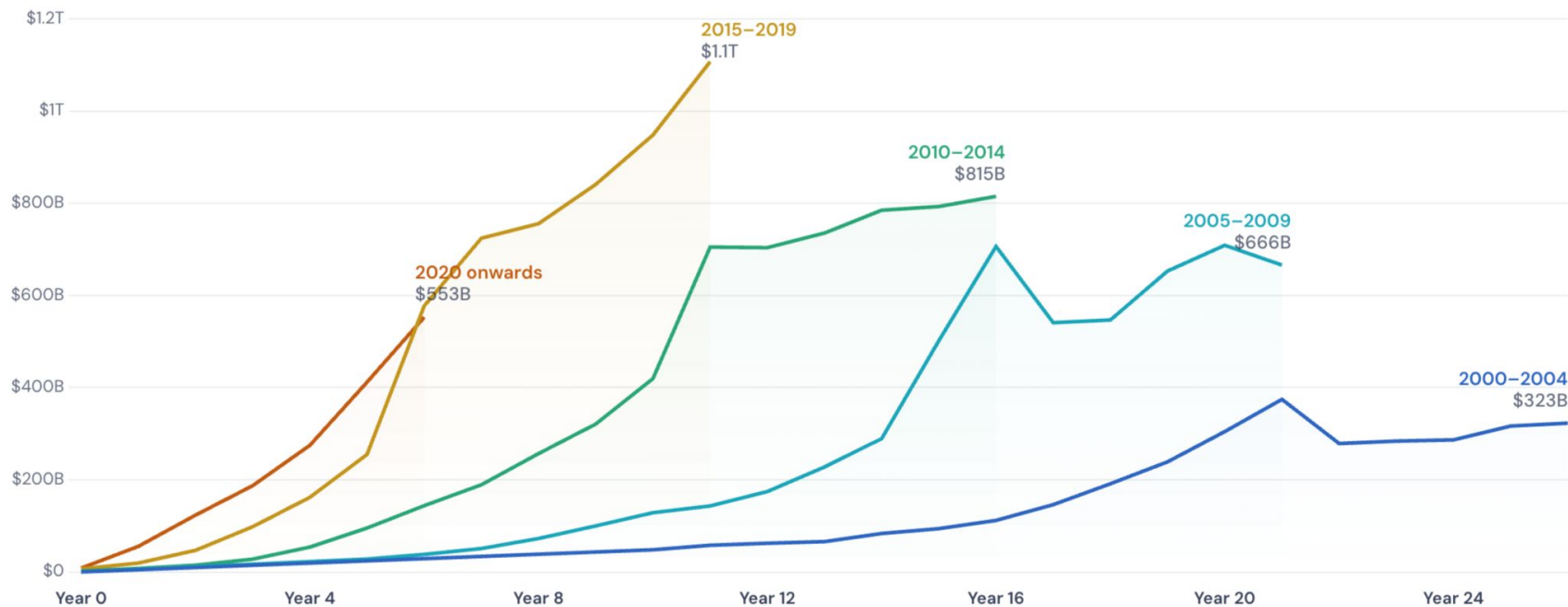
Europe's VC-backed ecosystem has grown to \$4.3 trillion

Combined enterprise value of VC backed companies founded since 1990



Latest generations of startups are scaling faster than ever before

Combined enterprise value of VC-backed European startups by year founded cohort



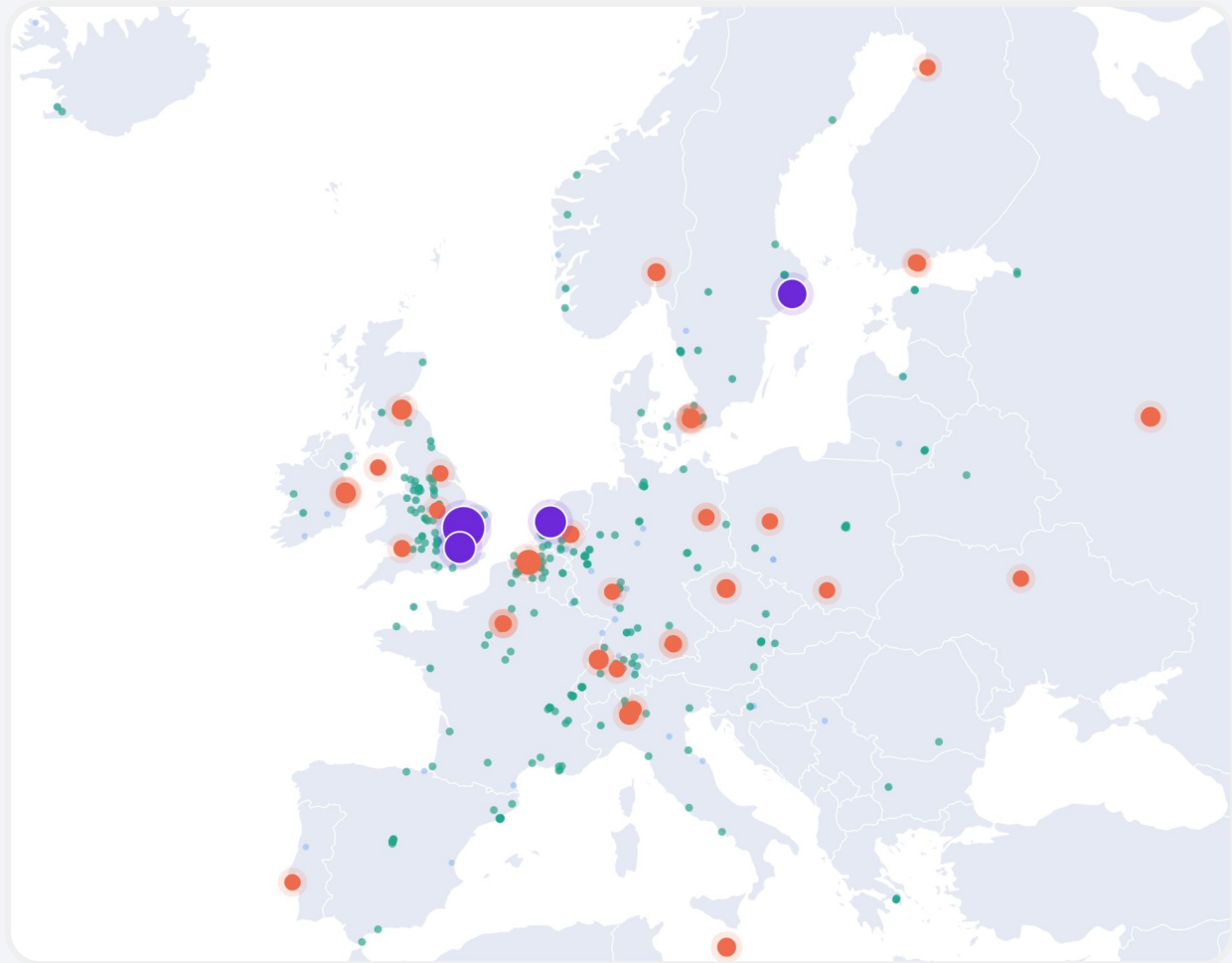
Power Law Outcomes

~800 thoroughbreds

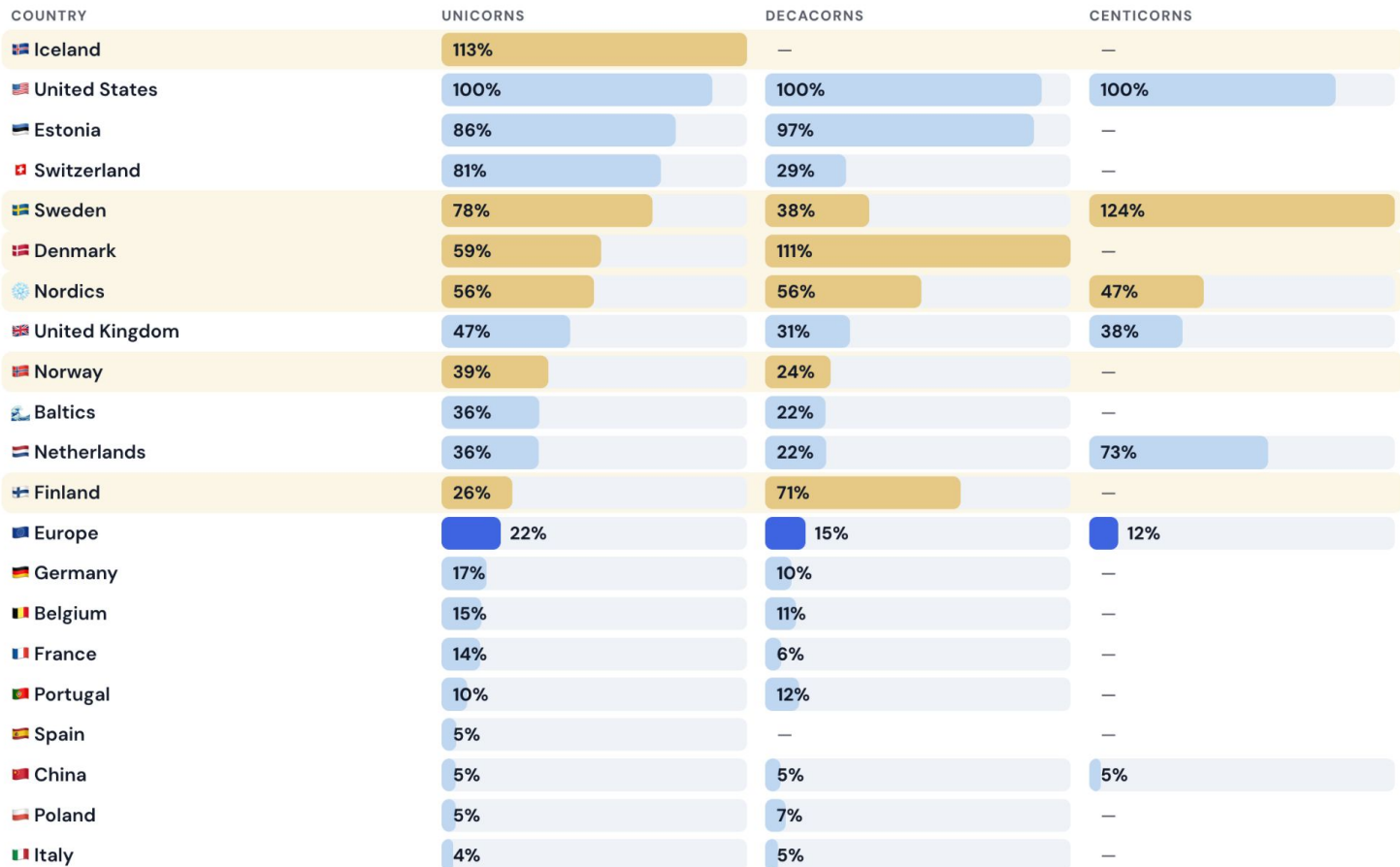
~700 unicorns & \$1B exits

53 decacorns

4 centicorns



Nordics are rivalling US

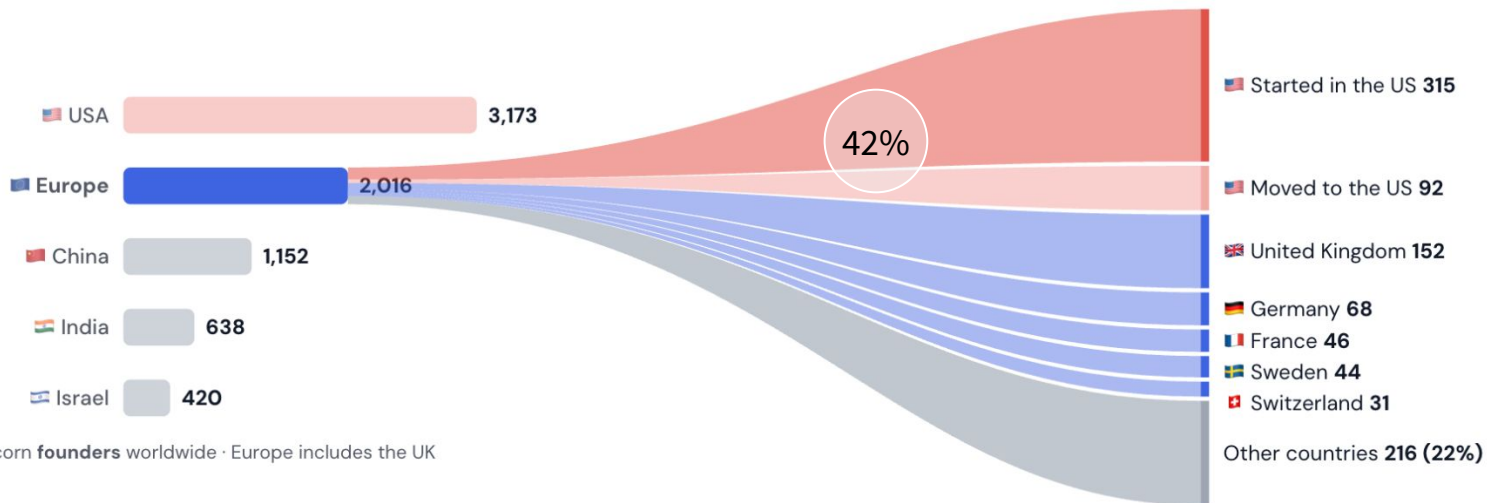


Europe has the entrepreneurial talent but many choose the US to build

European Unicorn Founders

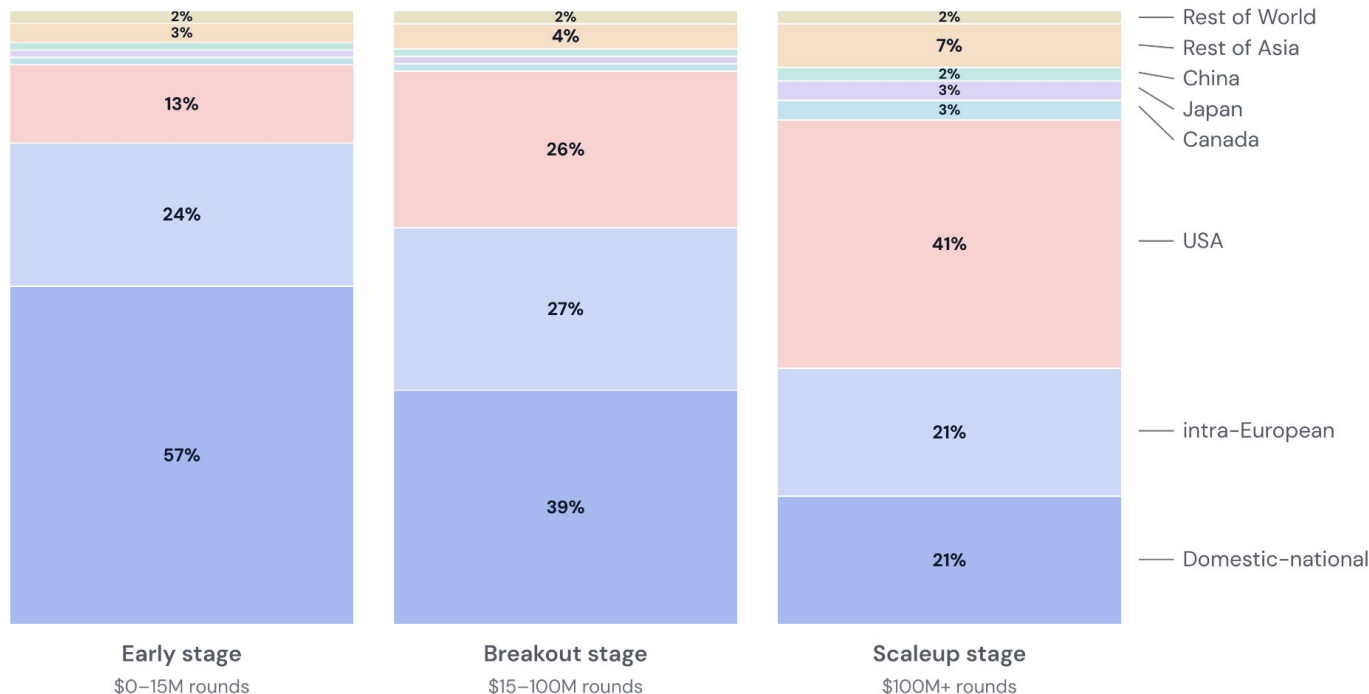
● Started in the US ● Moved to the US ● Built in Europe ● Other countries

The 964 unicorns they founded — by where they were built



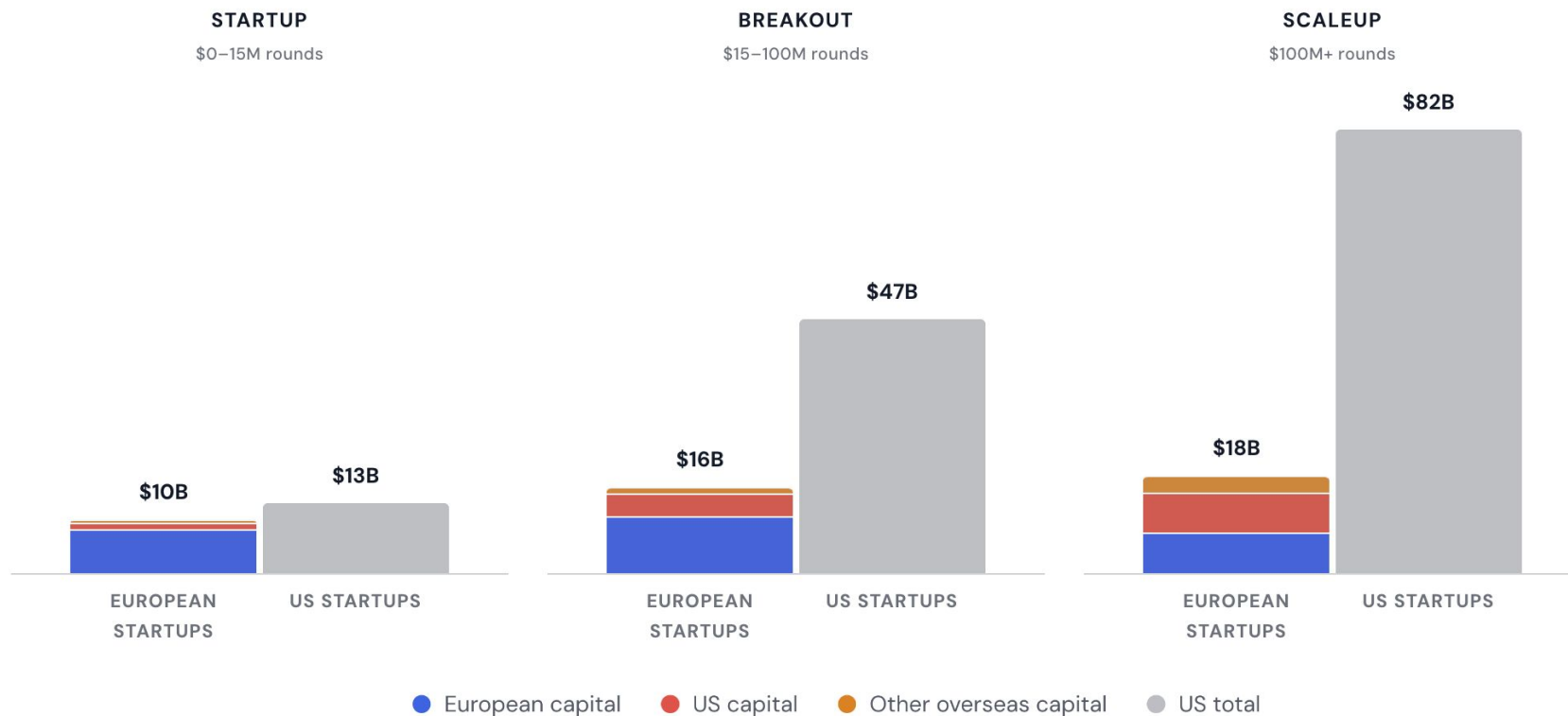
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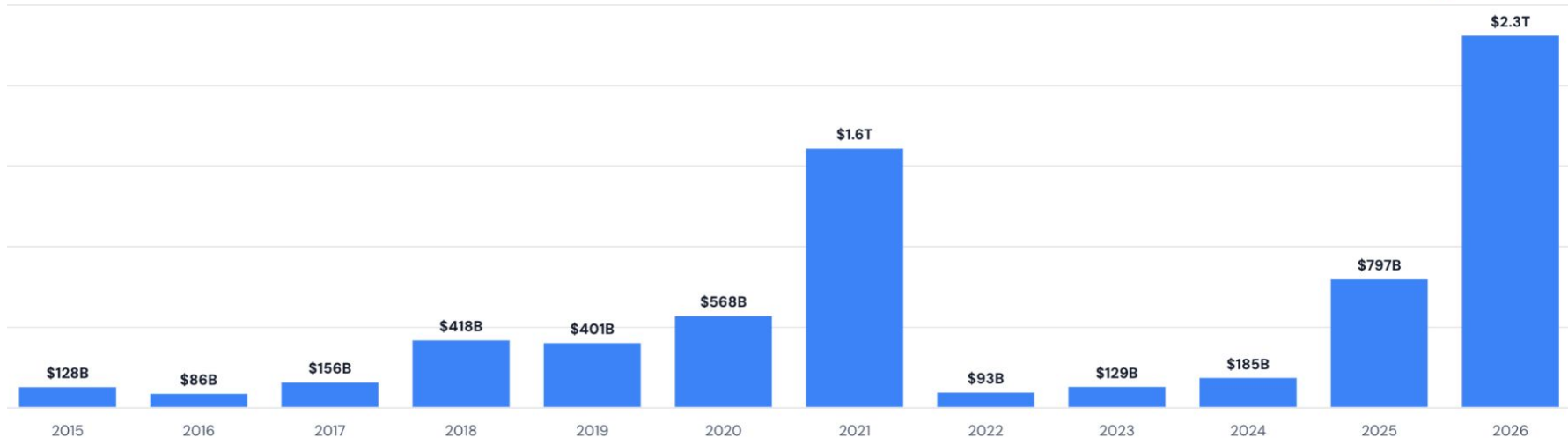
Top US firms are doubling tripling down on Europe

Investment into Europe by leading US firms



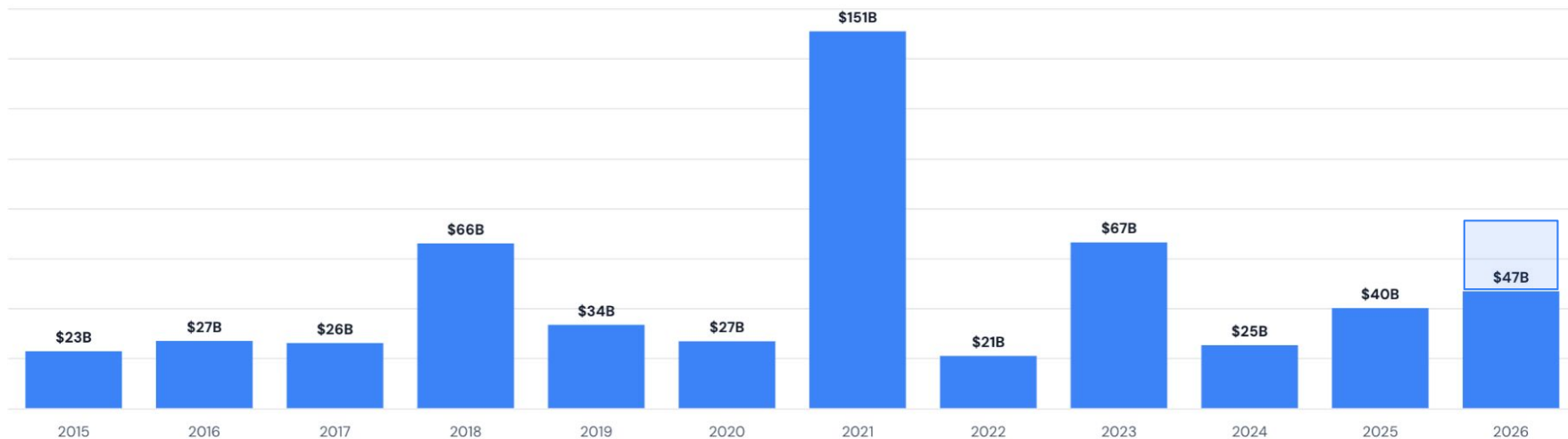
Global VC-backed Exits (first-time)

First-time VC backed exits globally



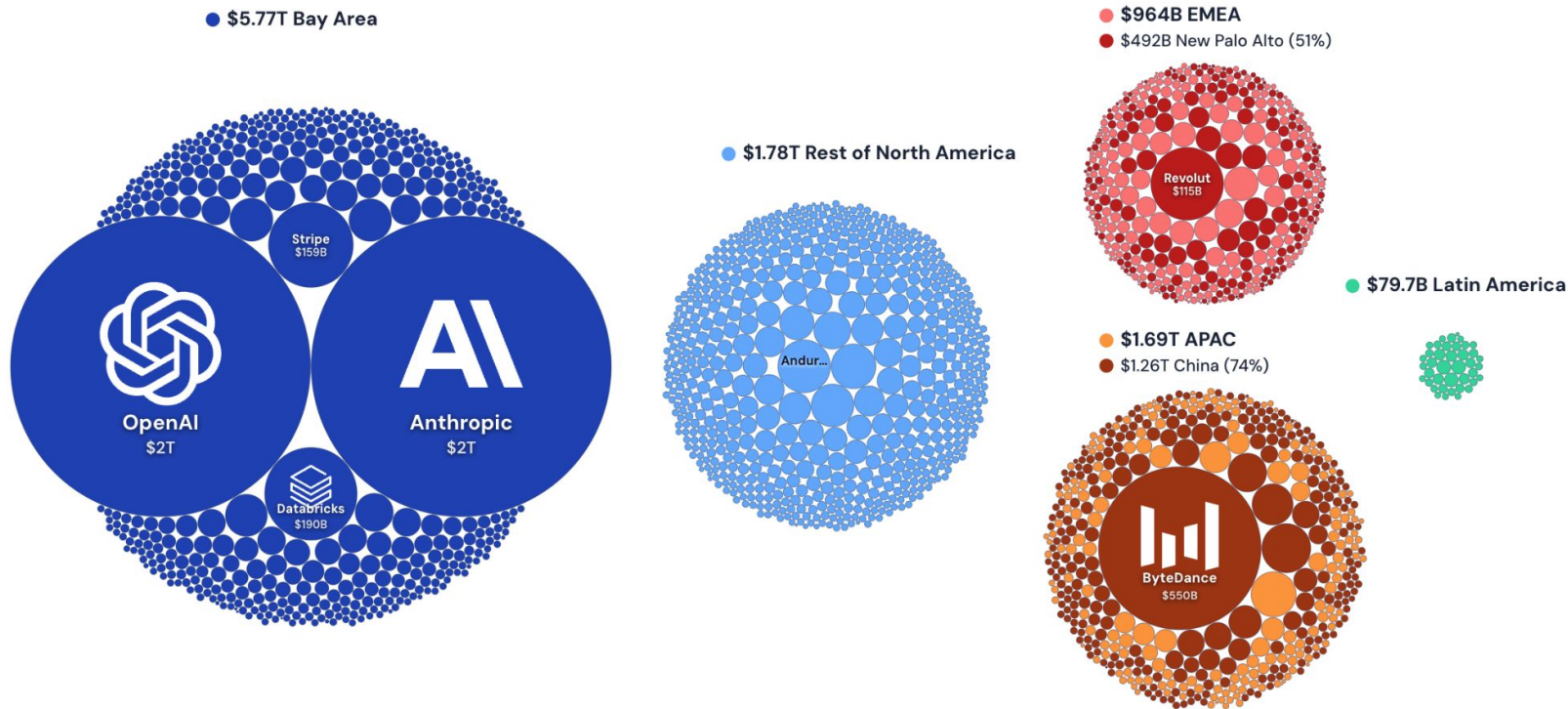
In Europe, VC-backed exits could reach \$75B this year, the second highest ever

First-time VC backed exits in Europe (incl. Bending Spoons, Quantinuum)



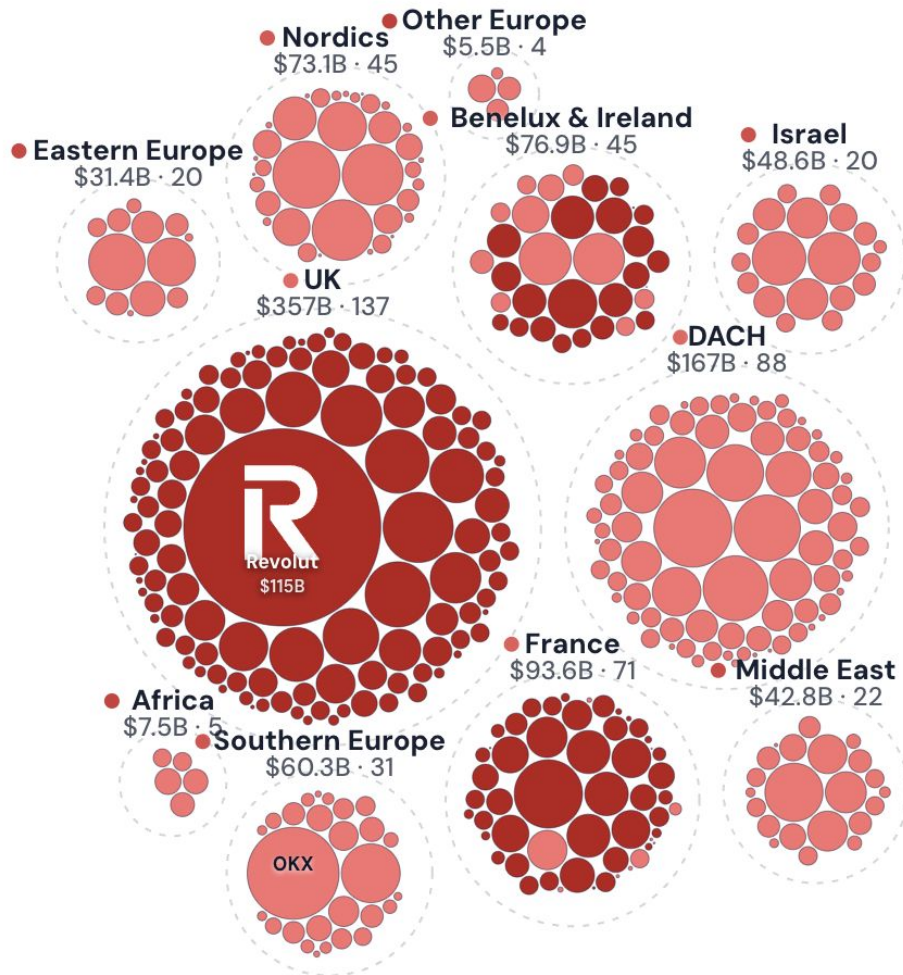
Future exit pipeline: respectable \$1 trillion in EMEA, out of \$10 trillion globally

Private \$1B+ companies in EMEA

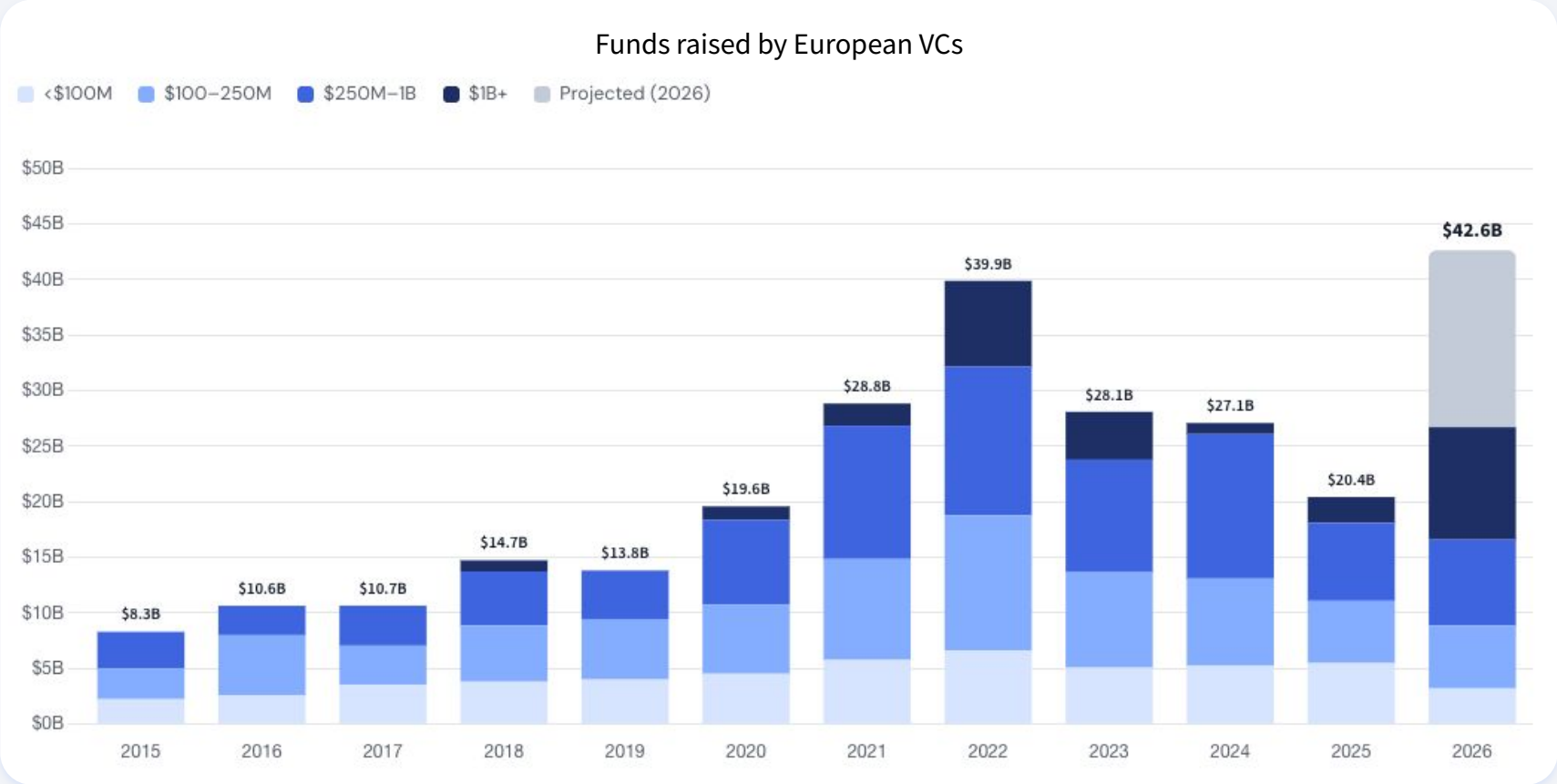


EMEA pipeline of private \$1B+ companies

(think Helsing, Hugging Face, ICEEYE, Celonis, Odoo, Bolt, etc)



Record fundraising by European VC firms

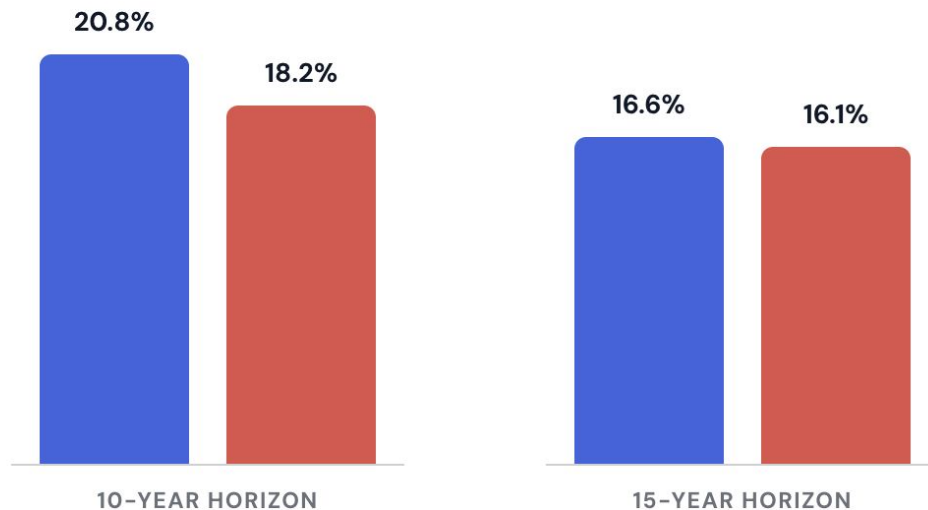


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● Europe venture

● North America venture

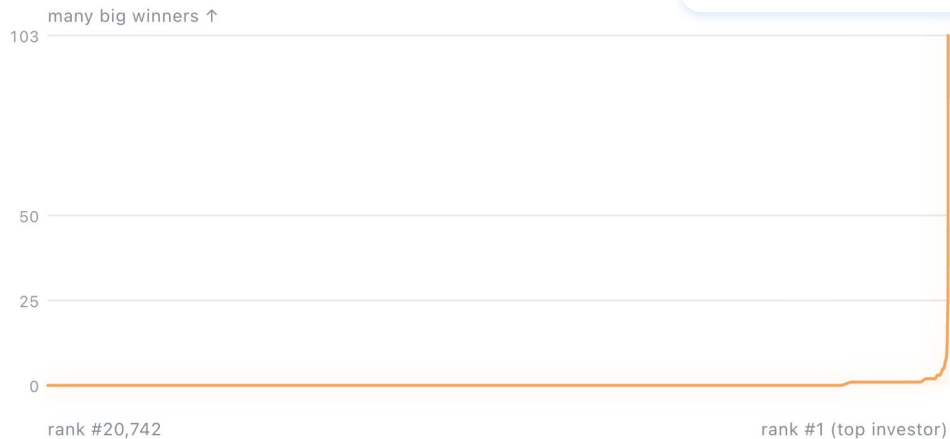


Source: Invest Europe / Cambridge Associates, The Performance of European Private Equity (2024) *



The Power Law and Access in VC

Global 20K investors

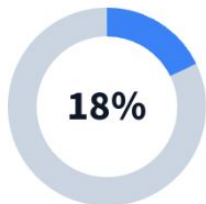


Global top 100 investors

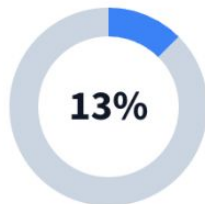


Europe is a significant chunk of global tech – and it's still early

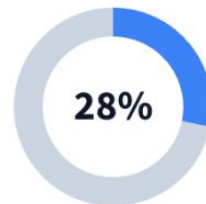
Unicorns



Decacorns

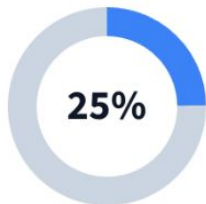


\$100M+ revenue



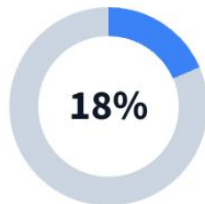
VC · startup rounds

\$1–15M



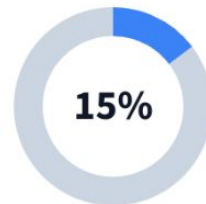
VC · breakout rounds

\$15–100M



VC · scaleup rounds

\$100M–2.5B



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